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At SCO, PM demands end to terror havens

With Shehbaz Sharif in the room, PM Narendra Modi warns that no nation can weaponise the menace of terror

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

Prime Minister Narendra Modi delivered a strong message on terrorism at the 26th Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) Summit, calling for the dismantling of the terror ecosystem and making it clear that there can be "no room for double standards" in the fight against the menace.

"We must speak with one voice that there can be no room for double standards on this serious issue. Countries that use terrorism as an instrument of policy, and that provide shelter and support to terrorists, must be given a firm message: terrorism cannot be a strategic asset for anyone," the PM was speaking at a roundtable discussion attended by Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif and other SCO leaders including Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President Vladimir Putin, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Belarusian President Alexander Lukashenko, Kazakhstan President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, Uzbek President Shavkat Mirziyoyev and Tajik President Emomali Rahmon.

Speaking about the broader security challenges facing the region, the PM said the "perimeter of security" had widened in an increasingly interconnected world.

"In today's connect-



PM Modi at the SCO Council of Heads of State Meeting, in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan PTI

SCO PHOTO GETS A CROP

New Delhi: Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif's office briefly posted a cropped version of the SCO summit family photograph, omitting several leaders while retaining Sharif prominently in the frame. The edited image circulated online before Sharif later shared the complete photograph featuring Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Russian President

Vladimir Putin and other SCO leaders. The episode drew attention on social media as the summit focused on regional security, terrorism, trade, connectivity and geopolitical challenges. The photo controversy unfolded against the backdrop of a summit focused on regional security, terrorism, economic cooperation, connectivity and wider geopolitical challenges.

FULL REPORT ON >> P4

ed world, the perimeter of security has grown even wider. The crisis in West Asia has shown that conflict in one region does not remain confined to that region alone... its effects are felt across the world's energy security, maritime trade, and supply chains," he said.

He said countries of the global South bear the heaviest cost of such conflicts

and reiterated India's position that wars and tensions must be resolved through dialogue and diplomacy. "Countries of the global South bear the heaviest cost of this. That is why India has consistently called for all tensions and wars to be resolved not on the battlefield, but through dialogue and diplomacy," PM Modi said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

MAMATA KIN DIES, PROBE UNDERWAY

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata

In a tragic incident, a niece of former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee, Bristy Mukherjee was found dead in at her Birbhum district house, West Bengal police said on Tuesday.

The body of Bristi Mukherjee (28), the daugh-



Bristi Mukherjee, niece of former West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee PTI

ter of Banerjee's maternal cousin Nihar Mukherjee, was recovered from a room on the second floor of her house at Kusumba village in Rampurhat area on Tuesday afternoon.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

SC invokes special powers to scrap FIRs over CJP protests

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday invoked its special powers under Article 142 of the Constitution to quash all FIRs against student protesters who faced FIRs for participating the Cockroach Janata Party-led protests between July 20 and 25, except those with criminal antecedents. CJP spokesperson Saurav Das told the SC that after Government's positive response and the court's order, the group has decided to withdraw its call for the September 5 protest. This followed a submission by Delhi Police and Governments of four NDA-ruled States, that the cases filed against protesters regarding the July 20 CJP protest will be withdrawn and no new cases will be filed in the future regarding the same protest.

A Bench of Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant, Justice Joymalya Bagchi, and Justice V Mohana quashed criminal cases after the Union Government and respective State Governments moved



ISTOCK

applications to seek quashing of the cases.

Article 142 empowers the SC to pass any orders to do complete justice. The Bench said its invocation of Article 142 was subject to both sides abiding by the understanding reached before it. "All FIRs mentioned are hereby quashed. If there is any other FIR registered with regard to same incidents of protests between 20-25 July in any State/UT which is not formally brought to our notice, they shall not be pursued or investigated and shall be taken as closed for all intents and purposes," the Bench said.

Welcoming the SC order, Union health minister JP Nadda said the welfare and progress of the country's youth remained the Government's utmost priority.

The Bench, also took note of the submissions of Solicitor General Tushar Mehta and widened the ambit of its order. "If there is any other FIR registered with regard to same protest between July 20 to July 25 in any of the states or UTs, which are not before this court, they shall not be pursued and will be treated as closed," it said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Ram temple trust moves to name new CEO

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ Ayodhya/Lucknow

The Sri Ram Janmabhoomi Teerth Kshetra Trust, which manages the Ram temple in Ayodhya, on Wednesday is expected to make major administrative decisions, including the announcement of a full-time Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the temple. A three-member panel of retired Justice Pramod Kohli, retired Lieutenant General Vishnukant Chaturvedi, and expert member Suresh Haware appointed by the temple trust have shortlisted three names for the CEO from among 5,585 applications received by the trust after advertising the post in July.



Ram temple trust chief Nritya Gopal Das, centre, with members during a meeting on appointing a new general secretary, filling three vacant trustee posts and the future administrative structure of the temple trust on July 23 PTI

The trust is expected to choose the CEO at a meeting on Wednesday at Maniramdas Chhawani, the home of trust president Mahant Nritya Gopal Das. Officials said the meeting will likely start around 2pm. The three shortlisted names

have not been made public. "We sought this guidance because we were in search of an excellent CEO to ensure the superior management of such a big, world-renowned temple," said trust treasurer Swami Govind Dev Giri. The deci-

sion comes after a June controversy over alleged theft and embezzlement of offerings, which led to an FIR, several arrests, and the resignations of former general secretary Champat Rai and trustee Anil Mishra.

Candidates had to be practising Hindus aged 50 to 70, with at least 20 years of experience managing large institutions and a clear devotion to Lord Ram. Preference went to those willing to live in Ayodhya. Justice Kohli said he was surprised by the number of applications.

The interviewees included former IAS and IPS officers, Army veterans, and professionals from corporate, education, and temple administration backgrounds.

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NCLT BARS SUBHASH CHANDRA FROM SELLING ASSETS

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

A five-member special bench the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Tuesday barred Essel Group chairman Subhash Chandra from alienating his properties and issued notices to all parties in a case over a proposed settlement that would allow creditors to recover just about ₹6.5 crore from his personal eState against claims of roughly ₹22,006 crore.

The special bench of the NCLT, headed by President Justice Anupinder Singh



Essel Group chairman Subhash Chandra WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Grewal, said there was no majority view among its members and therefore, no final order could yet be given effect to.

The bench issued notice to all parties involved and directed that the guarantor "shall not alienate the properties, either directly or indirectly".

Justice Grewal said the tribunal wanted to understand the scope of the matter and would hear all parties, including creditors who have opposed Chandra's repayment plan.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

CBI probes ₹29 crore rice diversion case

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has initiated a formal investigation into suspected irregularities in the allocation of subsidised rice by the Food Corporation of India (FCI) to the North Eastern Regional Agricultural Marketing Corporation (NERAMAC).

The agency registered a case on 27 August 2026 following a preliminary enquiry and reports from the Union Food Ministry and FCI's vigilance wing.

The FIR was filed by CBI's Anti-Corruption Unit-III in New Delhi and assigned to Deputy Superintendent of Police Mukesh Kumar.

Anil Kumar Yadav, Superintendent of Police, CBI AC-III, signed the document. The case invokes Section 6(2), read with Section 318(4), of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023 (criminal conspiracy and cheating), and Section 7 of the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988.

According to the FIR, FCI's Delhi Region allotted 62,000 metric tonnes (MT) of rice to NERAMAC between 13 April and 15 May 2026 under the Open Market Sale Scheme (Domestic) or OMSS(D) 2025-26. Of this, NERAMAC lifted approximately 50,645 MT at a concessional rate of ₹23,200 per MT.

The prevailing reserve price at the time was ₹28,900 per



MT. Had the same quantity been sold through the mandated e-auction at the reserve price, FCI would have realised an additional ₹28.87 crore.

The complaint came from Rizwan Ahmed, Section Officer (Vigilance) in the Department of Food and Public Distribution. He sent two important documents: A Neutral Committee report from 30 June 2026 and FCI's Vigilance Factual Report from 22 July 2026.

These reports looked at how FCI's Delhi Region allotted 62,000 metric tonnes of rice to NERAMAC between 13 April and 15 May 2026 under the Open Market Sale Scheme (Domestic) 2025-26.

Out of this, 50,645 MT was taken at ₹23,200 per MT, which was below the reserve price of ₹28,900 per MT. This led to an estimated loss of ₹28.87 crore for FCI.

Investigators found that NERAMAC, a central public-sector company, was not eligible for allocation without an e-auction under the July 2025 OMSS(D) policy.

This policy allowed such concessional sales only for state governments and their corporations.

FCI officials are accused of processing the proposal too quickly. Meanwhile, NERAMAC officials brought in three private firms, Utapalakshi Agro Products, Dibesh Commercial

and Super Grains, through agreements that were not properly checked.

The CBI is looking into several specific areas. Sleuths are piecing together the full paper trail, including letters sent by NERAMAC Additional General Manager Anjal Kumar Dutta to the Delhi Food Minister in January 2026, the no-objection certificate from the Delhi Food Department in April 2026, and the purchase orders from the private traders. They are also checking bank records to track deposits made by Delhi-NCR traders into NERAMAC accounts and the commissions of Rs 0.64 to 2.50 per kg paid to them.

Investigators are examining whether any of the rice actually reached the intended beneficiaries, such as daily-wage earners, labourers, and migrant workers without ration cards, or was instead sold in the open market.

They are also looking at fake distribution charts and backdated appointment letters for 23 sub-distributors.

The FIR lists eight people: three former FCI Delhi Region officers (Kunhiraman Padmini Asha, Brahm Prakash and Amarendra Vikram), three former NERAMAC officers (Bhaskar Barua, Anjal Kumar Dutta and Dilip Saha), and two private traders (Rajesh Bajaj and Pankaj Saraf).

The FIR also mentions "unknown public servants" and "unknown others." The parent organisations had already suspended several of the named officials between May and June 2026 after internal inquiries. As of 1 September 2026, five days after the case was registered, the investigation is still in the document-collection and witness-examination stage.

The agency is seeking records from FCI headquarters, NERAMAC's Guwahati office, the Delhi Food Department and relevant banks. The agency is investigating whether additional officials, including those in the Delhi Government who processed the no-objection, played any role.

Traffic hit on 35 roads for BRICS Summit motorcade rehearsal, 22 diversions announced

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

On Tuesday, commuters in Delhi faced major disruptions as the Delhi Traffic Police issued a wide-ranging traffic advisory for a full motorcade rehearsal ahead of the BRICS Summit 2026. From 11.00 AM to 3.00 PM, restrictions and controlled movement were enforced along high-security VVIP routes, impacting over 35 roads and 22 diversion points in central and south Delhi.

The Delhi Traffic Police has issued a traffic advisory ahead of the motorcade rehearsal for the BRICS Summit 2026, announcing that restrictions and diversions will affect several key roads in the national Capital on September 2.

The rehearsal will be held from 10 am to 3 pm. According to Ministry of External Affairs statement, the 18th BRICS Summit will take place from September 12 to 13 at Bharat Mandapam in Pragati Maidan.

The advisory said traffic movement will be regulated at 22 diversion points and on more than 35 roads during the rehearsal.

Motorists have been advised to plan their journeys and use alternate routes wherever possible.

Major roads likely to be affected include Sardar Patel Marg, Mother Teresa Crescent,



Teen Murti Marg, Akbar Road, Tees January Marg, Rajesh Pilot Marg, Subramaniam Bharti Marg, Mathura Road, Moti Lal Nehru Marg, Dr Zakir Hussain Marg, Brigadier Hoshar Singh Marg, Africa Avenue Road, Satya Marg, Shanti Path, Janpath, Ashoka Road, Barakhamba Road, Tolstoy Marg, Ranjeet Singh Flyover, Niti Marg, Panchsheel Marg, Kamal Ataturk Marg, A P J Abdul Kalam Road and Press Enclave Road.

The traffic police has identified several diversion points, including Dr Dinesh Nandini Dalmia Chowk, Ram Charan Aggarwal Chowk, Mir Dard Chowk, Kasturba Gandhi Marg/Outer Circle, Janpath-Connaught Place, Patel Chowk, RML Hospital roundabout, Dhula Kuan flyover, Moti Bagh flyover, Lodhi Road and Mandir House.

Officials said traffic approaching the controlled stretches will be diverted through alternate corridors such as Ring Road, IP Marg, BSZ Marg, Delhi Gate, Sikandra Road, Lodhi Road, Aurobindo Marg, Vande Mataram Marg and other arterial routes.

The advisory provides alternate routes for passengers travelling to New Delhi, Old Delhi and Hazrat Nizamuddin railway stations. Travellers heading to the airport have been advised to use the Metro, particularly during the advisory window.

For passengers travelling from Gurugram, Dwarka, New Delhi, South Delhi, West Delhi and North and East Delhi, the traffic police has suggested specific road corridors to reach the airport while avoiding regulated stretches.

Officials said Metro services will remain operational, while bus routes may face diversions during VIP movements. Taxis and auto-rickshaws will not be permitted to park along roads except at designated locations.

78,000 old heavy vehicles identified for voluntary switch to BS-VI ahead of pollution season

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

From identifying nearly 78,000 Delhi-registered old heavy vehicles for voluntary transition to cleaner BS-VI models to constituting district-level task forces and expanding construction waste collection sites, the Delhi Government is gearing up for the pollution season.

The Government has also stepped up dust monitoring through its anti-pollution portal, launched in July, with AI-enabled cameras identifying around 2,000 sites where prescribed anti-pollution measures were not being



followed, officials said. "DCs, DMs and other officials will be working at the district level to identify traffic hotspots and pollution hotspots and find local engineering solutions. We have asked the districts to submit their responses by the end of this month," a senior

Government official told PTI.

The district-level task forces, headed by deputy commissioners and district magistrates along with other officials, have been asked to identify pollution and traffic hotspots and prepare local solutions based on conditions in individual areas.

The Government is also taking the vehicle transition campaign as part of the Centre's ₹9,585 crore Parivartan scheme, which seeks to accelerate the transition to cleaner commercial vehicles in the National Capital Territory of Delhi and NCR districts in Haryana, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh.

Museum to come up at Delhi Assembly complex, Speaker tells DU students

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Assembly Speaker Vijender Gupta on Tuesday announced plans to build a museum within the Assembly complex, showcasing the site's history, constitutional legacy and architectural heritage. The speaker made the announcement while addressing Delhi University students under the Secretariat's Youth Outreach Initiative.

Gupta said the proposed museum would display rare historical artifacts, archival documents and interactive exhibits tracing the evolution of local governance in Delhi.



He said the plan involves converting parts of the historic 1912 building into a curated public space, offering visitors a direct link to foundational moments in the country's legislative history.

The Speaker said the initiative was intended to serve as

an experiential learning hub for the capital's youth and scholars, adding that giving citizens direct access to the seat of local democracy would strengthen civic ownership and deepen public appreciation for India's democratic traditions.

Odonil bets on regional storytelling to make bathroom freshness a household habit

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Odonil, India's leading air freshener brand from Dabur India Ltd., has unveiled its campaign, "Bathroom mein Odonil nahi, toh aapki badnaami ho rahi hogi kahin," conceptualised by Pepper Content.

Odonil has developed seven culturally native films rooted in the cultural and social dynamics of seven states, while anchored in a universal consumer insight: a bathroom without Odonil can influence how guests perceive the host.

"By addressing a familiar social reality through humour and regional narratives, Odonil aims to make bathroom freshness a more integral part of how Indian consumers care for and welcome guests," said Mr Abhishek Jugran, Director Marketing, Dabur India Ltd.

The campaign spans Delhi, Maharashtra, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh & Telangana, Punjab and West Bengal, and will be amplified through regional creators and influencers, strengthening category relevance and making bathroom freshness a visible home-care habit.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform to all concern that Sh. Rajender S/o Shri Jugal Kishore R/o Vill- Barolia, Rajput Colony, Sector-49, Noida U.P., who is the original owner of Residential Plot No.096, Block-B, Sector-92, Noida (U.P) Sh. Rajender expired on 19.01.2023.

The WILL was executed in favour of Smt. Vidhya W/o Sh. Gajraj Singh & Mrs. Geeta W/o Sh. Rupesh Kumar both R/o B-2, Harkesh Nagar, New Delhi-110020, which is registered in Sub Registrar First, Noida, Bahi No.3, Dt. 21.04.2011. So it is informed to all concern that the said Property Plot No.096, Block-B, Sector-92 Noida (U.P) is going to be transferred in favour of Smt. Vidhya W/o Sh. Gajraj Singh & Mrs. Geeta W/o Sh. Rupesh Kumar both R/o B-2, Harkesh Nagar, New Delhi-110020. If anyone has/have any objection he/she may file his/her objection alongwith the sufficient proof in the Residential Plot Department of the Noida Authority within 15 days from the date of publication of this notice.

Smt. Vidhya & Mrs. Geeta

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public that Sh. Sayyad Amir Abbas and Sh. Sayyad Mohabbat Ali, both sons of Sh. Rifakat Ali, have jointly agreed to sell to the undersigned the following land situated at Village Civil Station, Civil Lines, New Delhi-110064, free from all encumbrances:

1). Kharsa No. 730/416, admeasuring 7 Bigha 16 Biswa; 2). Kharsa No. 731/416, admeasuring 11 Bigha 6 Biswa; and 3). Kharsa No. 732/416, admeasuring 9 Bigha 7 Biswa.

Any person, authority, department, financial institution or any other entity having or claiming any right, title, interest, share, lien, charge, claim, objection or demand of whatsoever nature in respect of the aforesaid land, or any part thereof, is hereby required to make the same known in writing, along with supporting documentary proof, to the undersigned within 14 (fourteen) days from the date of publication of this notice. In the event no such claim, objection or demand is received within the aforesaid period, the same shall be deemed to have been waived and/or abandoned, and the undersigned shall proceed to complete the transaction with the aforesaid sellers without any further reference to such claim, objection or demand. No claim thereafter shall be entertained or shall be binding upon the undersigned.

Sd/-
Adv. MOHAMMAD ABUBAKR ABDULLAH
Lawyer's Chamber-V-13, Opposite SBI Bank, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi-110054
Email: solicitoridellhi@gmail.com

**Baba Farid University of Health Sciences**

Sadiq Road, Faridkot-151203, Ph: 01639-256232, 256236

Admission Notice to MBBS/BDS Courses under NEET UG-2026 (2nd Round)

Fresh online Registration/Applications are invited through University website from eligible candidates on the basis of NEET-UG-2026 for vacant seats as per Punjab Govt. Notification/Prospectus for admission to MBBS/BDS Courses in Govt./Private Colleges, Private Universities and Minority Institutions in the State of Punjab w.e.f **03.09.2026 to 05.09.2026**. Last date is **03.09.2026 to 07.09.2026**. Online Counseling will be conducted as per schedule published on the University website. Any update issued by MCC/Govt. of India/Govt. of Punjab regarding UG admissions session 2026 shall be applicable.

For Prospectus/Schedule/Fee/Details and updates visit at www.bfuhss.ac.in

Sd/-
REGISTRAR

3108/12/2026-27/14732 Dated CHD :- 01/09/2026

**OFFICE OF THE PROJECT MANAGER, CONSTRUCTION UNIT, UTTARAKHAND PEYJAL NIGAM**

GHINGARIKHAL, RANIKHET, DISTT.- ALMORA 263645

Letter No.: 1992/Nivida/81 **E-Tender Notice** Date : 29-08-2026

Sl. No.	Name of the work	Tender Value without GST (Rs. In Lakh)	Period of Completion
1.	RENOVATION WORK AT GOVT. BAL SHISHU GRAH AND BAL KISHORI GRAH BAKH ALMORA, DISTT. -ALMORA.	39.60	08 Months

2. Date and Time of availability of Bid documents in the portal: 01-09-2026 (17.00 hrs)
3. Online Bid submission: End date :- 21-09-2026 (17.00 hrs)
4. Date & Time of bid Opening :- 22-09-2026 (13.00 hrs)
5. Name and Address of the Officer inviting bid: - Project Manager Construction Unit, Uttarakhand Peyjal Nigam, Ranikhet.
6. Pre-bid meeting details (if required) Date & Place :- 07-09-2026 (11.00 hrs) Project Manager Construction Unit, Uttarakhand Peyjal Nigam, Ranikhet.
7. For further details, details of subsequent Amendment / correction documentation etc. may be obtained from the e-Procurement portal www.uktenders.gov.in

PROJECT MANAGER

**RUNGTA IRRIGATION LIMITED**

REGD. & HEAD OFFICE:
101, Pragati Tower 26, Rajendra Place, New Delhi 110008
Tel: 011-40453330, 331,332 | CIN : L74899DL1986PLC023934
E-mail: info@runghtairrigation.in | Website: www.runghtairrigation.in

NOTICE OF 42nd ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING ("AGM") OF RUNGTA IRRIGATION LIMITED ("THE COMPANY") AND E-VOTING INFORMATION

Notice is hereby given that the 42nd AGM of the members of Runghta Irrigation Limited ("Company") will be held on Tuesday, September 29, 2026, at 12:00 P.M. (IST) through Video Conferencing ("VC") or Other Audio Visual Means ("OAVM") to transact the business(es) as set out in the Notice of the AGM ("Notice"). The proceedings of the AGM shall be deemed to be conducted at the Registered Office of the Company which shall be the deemed venue of the AGM.

- In compliance with the applicable provisions of the Companies Act, 2013 and the rules made thereunder, read with General Circular No. 09/2024 dated September 19, 2024 and other circulars issued by the Ministry of Corporate Affairs, and SEBI Circular No. SEBI/HO/CFD/CFD-PoD-2/PIR/2024/133 dated October 3, 2024 and other circulars issued by the Securities and Exchange Board of India ("SEBI"), and the SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 (including amendments, modifications or re-enactments thereof for the time being in force) ("SEBI Listing Regulations"), the Notice and Annual Report for the financial year ended March 31, 2026 ("Annual Report") have been sent only through electronic mode to those members whose names appear in the Register of Members / Register of Beneficial Owners maintained by the depositories, and whose e-mail addresses are registered with the Company / Registrar and Share Transfer Agent / Depositories / Depository Participant(s).
- The electronic dispatch of the Notice and Annual Report has been completed on Tuesday, September 01, 2026. The soft copy of the Notice and Annual Report is also available on the Company's website: www.runghtairrigation.in in the website of BSE Limited: www.bseindia.com and the website of NSDL: www.evoting.nsdl.com. Additionally, a letter providing the web-link, including the exact path, where complete details of the Notice and Annual Report are available, has also been dispatched to those shareholders who have not registered their e-mail addresses.
- The cut-off date for determining eligibility to vote by remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM shall be Tuesday, September 22, 2026 ("Cut-off date"). Shareholders of the Company whose names appear in the Register of Members / List of Beneficial Owners as on the Cut-off date shall be entitled to vote electronically either through remote e-voting or e-voting during the AGM on the resolutions set forth in the Notice. Persons not holding shares as on the Cut-off date may treat this communication for information purposes only. The voting rights of shareholders shall be in proportion to their shareholding in the paid-up equity share capital of the Company as on the Cut-off date.
- Any person who acquires shares and becomes a member of the Company after dispatch of Notice and holds shares as on the Cut-off date, may follow the process as provided in the Notice for remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM. Further, the members may also contact remote e-voting / e-voting during the AGM helpdesk at evoting@nsdl.com or call at 022 - 48867000.
- All the members are informed that:
 - The business set out in the Notice may be transacted through remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM;
 - The remote e-voting period is as follows:

Commencement of remote e-voting	Saturday, September 26, 2026 at 9.00A.M. (IST)
Conclusion of remote e-voting	Monday, September 28, 2026 at 5.00 P.M. (IST)
 - The remote e-voting module will be disabled by NSDL thereafter and Members will not be allowed to vote electronically beyond the said date and time;
 - Shareholders who have casted their vote(s) by remote e-voting prior to the AGM may also attend and participate in the AGM through VC/OAVM but shall not be entitled to cast their vote(s) again.
 - Facility for e-voting will also be available during the AGM and those members present in the AGM through VC/OAVM, who have not casted their vote on the resolution through remote e-voting and are not otherwise barred from doing so, shall be eligible to vote through the e-voting at the AGM in the manner as set out in the Notice.
 - Once the vote is casted by the member on a resolution, the member will not be allowed to modify or change his/her vote subsequently.
- Members of the Company holding shares in physical mode and who have not registered/updated their e-mail addresses can temporarily register their email addresses with the Company by sending scanned copy of the following documents by email to cs@runghtairrigation.in
 - A signed request letter mentioning your name, folio number and complete address;
 - A self-attested scanned copy of the PAN Card; and
 - A self-attested scanned copy of any document (such as Aadhaar Card, Driving Licence, Election Identity Card, Passport) in support of the address of the member as registered with the Company.Members who wish to permanently register/update their email addresses with the Company may follow below instructions:

Dematerialized Shares	Register/update the email addresses by following the process prescribed by the concerned DP.
Physical Shares	Shareholders are requested to register the e-mail address with RTA, by submitting Form No. ISR 1 & ISR 2 duly filled and signed by the holders along with self attested copy of your PAN card and Address proof viz Aadhaar Card, passport or front and back side of share certificate in PDF or JPEG format (upto 1 MB) at beetalrta@gmail.com . In case of any queries, shareholder may call on Tel.No.: 011-42959000-09, 011-29961281-283, 26051061
- The detailed procedure for e-voting and joining the AGM through VC/OAVM, including the manner in which members holding shares in physical/demat form and who have not registered their email address can cast their vote(s) through remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM, is provided in the Notice.
- In case of any queries, Members are requested to write to the RTA at beetalrta@gmail.com or to the Company at cs@runghtairrigation.in

Members are requested to carefully read the Notice and in particular, instructions for joining AGM, manner of casting vote through remote e-voting or e-voting at the AGM.

For and on behalf of the Board of Directors
Runghta Irrigation Limited Sd/-
Date: September 01, 2026
Place: Delhi
Rekha Rathore | Company Secretary & Compliance Officer

**CONTINENTAL CHEMICALS LIMITED**

CIN : L24123UP1984PLC014111
Regd. Office: A-7, Sector - VII, NOIDA, Distt.: Gautam Buddha Nagar, U.P Pin - 201301
Website : www.continentalchemicals.com; Email: info@continentalsoft.com; Ph. No: 91-120-2423316

PUBLIC NOTICE
Subject: Special Window for Transfer and Dematerialisation of Physical Securities

Pursuant to SEBI Circular No. HO/38/13/12/2026-MIRSD-P00/13750/2026 dated January 30, 2026, All Shareholders are hereby informed that a Special Window is hereby opened for a period of one year from February 05, 2026 to February 04, 2027 for transfer and dematerialisation ("demat") of physical securities which were sold/purchased prior to April 01, 2019. The special window shall also be available for such transfer requests which were submitted earlier and were rejected/ returned/ not attended to due to deficiency in the documents/ process/ or otherwise. Further, the securities so transferred shall be mandatorily credited to the transferee only in demat mode and shall be under lock-in for a period of one year from the date of registration of transfer. Such securities shall not be transferred/ lienmarked/pledged during the said lock-in period. Further, the cases involving disputes between transferor and transferee will not be considered in this window and may be settled by transferor and transferee through court/NCLT process. Further, securities which have been transferred to Investor Education and Protection Fund (IEPF) shall not be considered under this window for processing.

Shareholders are encouraged to take advantage of this opportunity by furnishing the requisite documents listed in the above mentioned circular to the Company or its Registrar and Share Transfer Agent (RTA), BEETAL Financial & Computer Services Pvt Ltd. at the earliest within the stipulated period at given addresses.

Continental Chemicals Limited A-7, Sector-7, Noida-201301 Tel: 91-120-2423316 Email: compliance@continentalsoft.com	BEETAL Financial & Computer Services Pvt Ltd. BEETAL HOUSE, 3rd Floor, 99, Madangir, Behind LSC, New Delhi - 110062, Ph.: 011-29961281-283, 26051061, 26051064, Fax: 011-29961284 Email: beetalrta@gmail.com , beetal@beetalfinancial.com
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For cases of queries, Shareholders are requested to contact the Company Secretary of the Company at compliance@continentalsoft.com or the RTA of the Company at beetalrta@gmail.com.
NOTE: Company has also published the same information before also in the Pioneer English and Hindi - Lucknow Edition Newspaper dated 24/02/2026, 25/04/2026 and 27/06/2026.

Shareholders holding securities of the company in physical form are advised to convert their physical share certificates in to dematerialised (demat) Form.

Yours Faithfully
For Continental Chemicals Limited Sd/-
Sakshi Dhawan
(Company Secretary & Compliance Officer)
Email: compliance@continentalsoft.com
Tel: 91-120-2423316

Dated: 01/09/2026

LOST & FOUND

This is for information of general public that the Original Title Deeds in respect of Plot of Land measuring about 271.73 Sq. Meters (325.00 Sq. Yards), bearing Plot/Property Municipal No.: F-101, F-BLOCK, Kharsa/Rectangle No.: 54, Kila No.: 23/1 and 23/2, situated in the area of Village Khureji Khas, Illaga Shahdara, Delhi State, Delhi, above now known as JAWAHAR PARK, West Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092, belonging to SHRI PARSHWANATH DIGAMBER JAIN MANDIR PRABANDH SAMITI (REGD.), have been mis-placed some-where in transit. Anyone finding the above original title deeds is requested to return the same to Shri Parshwanath Digamber Jain Mandir Prabandh Samiti (Regd.) at the following address or contact either the president of Prabandh Samiti at Cell no.: 9873273266 or the secretary of Prabandh Samiti at Cell no.: 9136680806, and the finder will be rewarded suitably.

Shri Parshwanath Digamber Jain Mandir Prabandh Samiti (Regd.),
F-101, Jawahar Park, West Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092.

Govt clears zero-cost rooftop solar plan for 2.3 lakh homes

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi households using up to 400 units of electricity a month will be able to install rooftop solar systems of up to 3 kW without paying any upfront cost under an amended solar policy approved by the Delhi government. The revised Delhi Solar Energy Policy, approved at the Cabinet's 40th meeting, aims to bring rooftop solar to 2.30 lakh households and add 500 MW of rooftop capacity by March 2027.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the move would make it easier for ordinary consumers to shift from simply using electricity to also generating it.

Under the new arrangement, eligible domestic con-

sumers with average monthly consumption of up to 400 units in 2025-26 will receive rooftop solar systems of up to 3 kW, subject to technical feasibility.

The Centre will provide a subsidy of ₹78,000, while the Delhi Government will provide an additional capital subsidy of the same amount.

The state Government will also cover the difference between the available subsidy and the tendered cost of the solar plant through an additional top-up.

The policy changes the earlier system in which consumers had to make an initial payment and receive financial benefits later.

The Government will now arrange the installation without an upfront payment from eligible households.

Solar vendors will also be responsible for operating and maintaining the systems for the first five years.

After that, consumers will have the option of taking maintenance support through the electricity distribution companies for the remaining life of the installation, which is expected to be around 25 years.

The existing electricity subsidy will continue after solar installation. Consumers using up to 200 units will remain eligible for the 100 per cent electricity subsidy.

The policy will also provide an energy-saving incentive to eligible consumers.

Surplus electricity generated by rooftop systems and supplied to the grid will be paid for at the average power purchase cost of the distribution company. According to the government, a 3 kW rooftop solar system can generate around 300 units of electricity.



Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Delhi Minister Ashish Sood during a press conference at Delhi Secretariat in New Delhi on Tuesday

tion company. According to the government, a 3 kW rooftop solar system can generate around 300 units of electricity.

A household consuming 200 units could therefore use the generated power and send excess electricity to the grid through net meter-

ing. The Government has also sought to reduce the time required to connect residential rooftop systems to the grid.

The net metering process, which earlier took about 75 days, has been reduced to 25 days. Application and registration fees for residential solar systems of up to 10 kW have also been waived.

The scheme will operate through a utility-led aggregation model. Indraprastha Power Generation Company Limited will select vendors through competitive bidding and will oversee installation, coordination with vendors, grievance redressal and consumer support.

The Government has set a separate target of adding 500 MW of new rooftop solar capacity by March 2027.

Solar installations on Government buildings are already underway. So far, 10,073 solar systems have been installed in Delhi, many

of them on Government buildings.

The Chief Minister said the policy is intended to strengthen Prime Minister Narendra Modi's PM Surya Ghar vision in Delhi while reducing the financial and practical difficulties that have discouraged households from adopting rooftop solar.

Power Minister Ashish Sood said the Cabinet decision would help institutionalise the government's free electricity programme while expanding access to rooftop solar. He said 2.30 lakh consumers would receive solar systems without an upfront cost. The Government said the revised policy is aimed at making rooftop solar more accessible to eligible households and expanding Delhi's renewable energy capacity.

Affluent seats see higher voter drop than seats with unauthorised colonies



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi's affluent Assembly constituencies have seen a 37.4 per cent fall in their electorate after the Special Intensive Revision (SIR), compared to a 35.7 per cent reduction in seats with a large number of unauthorised colonies and Jhuggi-jhopdi clusters.

The comparison covers eight affluent constituencies — New Delhi, Greater Kailash, Kasturba Nagar, Malviya Nagar, RK Puram, Jangpura, Model Town and Rajouri Garden — and 12 constituencies with unauthorised colonies (UCs) and JJ clusters — Okhla, Seelampur, Tughlaqabad, Brijwasan, Sangam Vihar, Kirari, Burari, Badarpur, Vikaspuri, Nangloi Jat, Karawal Nagar and Uttam Nagar. The draft electoral rolls of 70 Assembly constituencies in Delhi were published by the Delhi chief electoral officer's (CEO) office on Monday.

A total of 47.5 lakh out of 1.45 crore voters, across 70 Assembly segments, have been excluded from the draft rolls. The eight affluent constituencies had a combined 11,36,032 electors in the August 17 electoral roll. The draft published on Monday has 7,11,187 names, leaving 4,24,845 names out of the draft list.

The 12 constituencies with UCs and JJ clusters had 34,03,201 electors in the August 17 roll. Their number

has fallen to 21,88,733 in the draft, with 12,14,468 names not appearing in it. Within the affluent constituencies, RK Puram recorded the highest reduction at 44.4 per cent. Its electorate fell from 1,30,161 to 72,426 names appearing in the draft roll, with 57,735 names excluded from the list.

Kasturba Nagar saw a 43.9 per cent reduction, with its electorate falling from 1,37,365 to 77,036 and 60,329 names deleted from the draft list. In New Delhi, the electorate fell from 89,683 to 52,368, a reduction of 41.6 per cent, while 37,315 names were not included. Jangpura recorded a 41.4 per cent reduction, with its electorate falling from 1,45,823 to 85,497. Malviya Nagar saw a 38.5 per cent fall, from 1,48,627 to 91,346, while Model Town recorded a 37.2 per cent reduction, from 1,58,519 to 99,611.

Greater Kailash saw its electorate fall 34.9 per cent, from 1,77,885 to 1,15,790. Rajouri Garden recorded the lowest reduction among the posh constituencies of the national Capital, with its electorate falling from 1,47,969 to 1,17,113, a decline of 20.9 per cent.

The highest reduction among the constituencies with UCs and JJ clusters was recorded in Tughlaqabad, where the electorate fell by 47.8 per cent, from 1,92,419 to 1,00,386. The number of names excluded from the draft list was 92,033.

Minority, SC seats see 20-45% voter exclusion in SIR draft against 33% overall

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Minority-dominated and SC-reserved constituencies in the national Capital registered between 20 and 45 per cent voter exclusions against the overall figure of 33 per cent deletions that Delhi recorded at the draft stage in the ongoing Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise.

Officials said among all States and Union Territories where SIR has been taken up, Delhi has recorded the "highest percentage" of deletions overall at 33 per cent at the draft stage.

Okhla, one of the seven constituencies where minorities are in sizeable numbers, recorded a staggering 45 per cent removal of voters in the draft rolls of the constituency while Patel Nagar



(reserved) saw 42 per cent exclusions.

The draft electoral rolls of 70 Assembly constituencies in Delhi were published by the Delhi chief electoral officer (CEO) office on Monday. Across 70 Assembly segments, 47.5 lakh out of

1.45 crore voters have been excluded from the draft rolls. Okhla, currently held by AAP MLA Amantullah Khan, had 3,62, 813 voters out of which 1,63,829 (45 per cent) have been excluded, leaving 1,98,984 voters in the draft rolls. Other minority-domi-

nated constituencies in Delhi besides Okhla witnessed relatively lower exclusions, including 38 per cent in Chandni Chowk, 32 per cent in Ballimaran, 28 per cent in Mustafabad, 26 per cent in Babarpur, 24 per cent in Matia Mahal and 23 per cent in Seelampur.

The excluded number of voters in these constituencies was 48,405 in Chandni Chowk, 80,804 in Mustafabad, 55,264 in Babarpur, 49,640 in Ballimaran, 45,105 in Seelampur and 32,099 in Matia Mahal.

Although there was no pattern of voter exclusion across the 70 constituencies, minority dominated seats had witnessed relatively higher submission of enumeration forms as compared to general seats, during the door to door verification

exercise from June 30 to August 17.

Digitisation of completed forms of voters was 76.6 per cent in Seelampur, followed by Matia Mahal with 75.5 per cent, Babarpur at 72.9 per cent and Mustafabad at 71.9 per cent.

In the 12 SC-reserved seats in Delhi, 40 per cent voters in Karol Bagh were excluded in the draft rolls, followed by 39 per cent in Ambedkar Nagar, 37 per cent each in Deoli and Kondli, 33 per cent in Trilokpur, and 31 per cent each in Seemapuri and Sultanpur Majra.

The reserved constituencies that saw less than 30 per cent deletions were Gokalpur (25 per cent), Bawana (23 per cent), Madipur (23 per cent) and Mangol Puri (21 per cent).

The reserved consti-

ties with a high number of exclusions are Deoli (94,726), Patel Nagar (80,346), Kondli (75,930), Bawana (74,829), Karol Bagh (72,430), Seemapuri (68,227), Trilokpur (63,582), Ambedkar Nagar (63,260) and Gokalpur (60,625).

According to the Delhi CEO office, the voters whose names are excluded from the draft rolls have been put under the absent, shifted, dead, duplicate and others (ASDDO) category.

The Delhi CEO data said the highest contributor to the ASDDO category was permanently shifted or absent voters — 43,32,775 out of the total 47,56,722 voters have been excluded from the draft rolls.

The number of deceased voters was 2,82,412, while those enrolled at multiple places numbered 1,41,535.

Chirag Paswan receives death threat, office seeks security review

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Union Minister Chirag Paswan, a Z-category protectee, received a death threat by post on Tuesday. The threat includes a warning that he would be killed by "hardcore terrorists," prompting his office to seek an urgent security review from the Home Ministry.

Paswan, who heads the Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) and serves as Union Minister of Food Processing Industries, had his office write directly to Home Secretary Govind Mohan regarding the threatening communication.

"An unsigned communication containing two mobile numbers was received in the ministry today. Upon opening the same, it was found to contain a direct threat to the life of the Union Minister for Food Processing Industries," Alok Kumar Singh, Additional Private Secretary to Paswan, said in the letter.

According to the letter, the

threatening portion of the communication, excluding the mobile numbers mentioned in it, read: "You will be killed shortly by hardcore terrorists."

The letter stated that the contents of the communication, particularly its direct nature and the reference to "hardcore terrorists," were a matter of grave concern and raised serious apprehensions over the minister's safety and security.

Paswan's office has requested the Home Ministry to examine the matter on an urgent basis, seeking a thorough investigation into the origin, authenticity and circumstances surrounding the threatening communication.

"It is further requested that the security arrangements of the minister may be reviewed and suitably augmented, as considered necessary, in view of the threat perception and his scheduled public engagements," Singh said in the letter.

A copy of the letter has also been sent to the Private Secretary of the



Union Home Minister and the Delhi Police Commissioner, indicating the matter is being escalated across multiple levels of the security establishment.

The threat comes despite Paswan already holding Z-category securi-

ty cover, one of the highest tiers of protection provided to VIPs in India, typically involving armed commandos and round the clock security personnel.

The letter's request for enhanced security suggests his office believes

the current protection level may need strengthening in light of the threat. Officials said the contents of the letter and the circumstances surrounding its delivery would be examined as part of a broader security assessment.

Investigators are expected to trace the origin of the communication, including the two mobile numbers mentioned in it, as part of efforts to establish its authenticity and source.

Paswan, a prominent leader from Bihar and son of the late Ram Vilas Paswan, has been a Union Cabinet minister since 2024.

His party, the Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas), remains an important ally within the ruling coalition at the centre.

Further details about the threat, including whether authorities have identified any leads on its origin, were not immediately available.

The Home Ministry is yet to issue a public statement on the matter following receipt of Paswan's office's letter.

Govt bans curtains, films on bus windows, mandates panic buttons and fire extinguishers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Government has banned curtains and unauthorised films on bus windows and made functional panic buttons, fire extinguishers and first-aid kits mandatory for all buses operating in the capital, in fresh directions issued to bus operators on Tuesday.

The directions, issued by the Transport Department, apply to all bus operators plying in Delhi, including buses from other states, with specific emphasis on the safety of women and children passengers. Violations may invite action under the law, according to the department.

Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the Delhi government, under Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, remains committed to strengthening passenger safety across the public transport system and ensuring mandatory safety norms are implemented on the ground.

Under the new directions, every bus operator must ensure Vehicle Location Tracking Devices and panic buttons remain functional at all times, with panic buttons kept easily accessible to pas-



sengers. Buses must also carry serviceable fire extinguishers and first-aid kits, and must be parked during night hours or idle periods only at authorised, secure and well-lit locations.

In line with existing court directions, buses must not have curtains or unauthorised films fitted on windows, and prescribed transparency standards for windshields, rear windows and side windows must be strictly maintained.

The directions also lay down conduct requirements for drivers and crew. Staff must behave courteously with passengers, and driving under the influence of alcohol or any intoxicating substance has been strictly prohibited.

Drivers must carry valid driving licences, uniforms and PSV badges where applicable, while conductors must carry valid conductor licences, uniforms and PSV badges. Operators have been directed to verify all drivers, conductors, attendants and other staff before deployment.

Buses requiring an attendant must have one on board, and all doors must remain securely closed while the vehicle is moving. Crew members have also been directed to assist persons with disabilities while boarding or alighting.

Specific instructions have been issued regarding the safety of women passengers. Bus operators must sensitise drivers, conductors

and other crew about preventing harassment and the consequences of misconduct against women.

In case of any incident involving indecent behaviour, molestation, eve-teasing or any other offence against a woman passenger, the crew has been directed to immediately inform police and take the bus to the nearest police station, police post or PCR van.

Every bus must carry a valid Fitness Certificate and remain mechanically sound, along with compliance with applicable emission norms and a valid Pollution Under Control certificate.

Operators have also been told to follow designated bus lanes and applicable traffic rules, with passenger boarding and alighting permitted only at designated stops or authorised locations.

Stopping at unsafe or unauthorised points, particularly in the middle of roads or at intersections, has been strictly prohibited. Singh said safety measures must be implemented in practice and not remain confined to paperwork, adding that the Government would take strict action against violations as per law.

Delhi Police map sleeper bus route in teen gang-rape case using CCTV, phone location

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Delhi Police are mapping the route of the sleeper bus in which a 16-year-old girl was allegedly gang-raped earlier this month, using CCTV footage and the mobile phone location of one of the accused, with investigators also finding that the vehicle was issued eight challans in Uttar Pradesh in July, mostly for speeding, officials said.

One of the challans, issued in Hamirpur on July 23, was for ₹23,000 for allegedly operating the bus without a permit, while five of the eight challans were issued in Mathura. The total value of the challans was ₹54,000, police said. The bus was purchased in April and registered in Firozabad on April 28, according to the investigation.

Police are using CCTV footage collected from several locations, including Kashmere Gate, Timarpur parking and Pari Chowk in Greater Noida, to reconstruct the movement of the bus on the night of August 4. One of the cameras captured the bus getting onto the Hanuman Mandir flyover, which investigators believe will help establish its route.

The footage is being



analysed alongside the location data of the accused's mobile phone to map the bus's movements and identify the places where it may have stopped during the journey, a senior police officer said.

The victim's clothes, which allegedly bear blood and semen stains, have been sent to the Forensic Science Laboratory and will be matched with the DNA samples of the two accused, bus driver Kuldeep (39) and conductor Sandeep (26), both residents of Kanpur. It has been found that no verification of the accused was done by the bus company, according to police sources.

The victim's clothes, the seat cover and CCTV footage are expected to form impor-

tant pieces of evidence in the case, police said. The 16-year-old girl, who had left her home in Mainpuri after being scolded by her mother, boarded the bus at Pari Chowk in Greater Noida on a rainy night, believing the conductor's assurance that it would take her to Noida Sector 63, where her cousin lived.

The bus, however, was not on regular passenger service that night. It had been taken to a workshop in Surajpur, Greater Noida, for repairs after developing a technical fault and was subsequently being taken towards Kashmere Gate for painting, according to the travel company that operated it.

Police allege that the two accused picked up the girl

around 9 pm and proceeded towards Kashmere Gate. During the journey, they allegedly raped her inside the moving bus and threatened to kill her when she resisted.

The girl was abandoned near Kashmere Gate and later reached the police station in an auto-rickshaw, where she reported the incident. Delhi Police registered an FIR and got her medically examined, which confirmed rape, officials said.

With the help of CCTV footage, police traced the bus within a few hours and arrested Kuldeep and Sandeep from a parking lot in Timarpur. The bus was seized and the accused underwent potency tests, police said. During forensic examination, strands of the girl's hair were found inside the bus. Investigators are now examining the seat cover and other material recovered from the vehicle for further forensic evidence.

The bus had company-fitted curtains around its sleeper berths, which allegedly allowed the accused to conceal their activities from people outside. The travel company had earlier said the bus's CCTV cameras were not operational as it was undergoing renovation.

Shehbaz Sharif’s SCO snapshot sparks row

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif appears to have discovered a new diplomatic tool at the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit.

The episode began when Pakistan’s Prime Minister’s Office posted what appeared to be a carefully cropped version of the SCO family photograph. The original group picture showed leaders and senior officials from across the organisation standing together ahead of the 26th SCO Summit in Bishkek. But in the Pakistani Government’s first version, several figures had mysteriously disappeared from the frame-while Sharif remained prominently positioned near the centre.

For a few hours, the photograph seemed to tell a rather different story...Pakistan’s prime minister was surrounded by

some of the world’s most powerful leaders, with the composition looking almost tailor-made for a diplomatic album. Social media users quickly noticed that the image was not the complete summit photograph. The joke practically wrote itself...perhaps the editing team had decided that diplomacy was complicated enough without allowing too many people into one picture.

The full photograph showed SCO Secretary-General Nurlan Yermekbayev alongside Belarusian President Alexander Lukashenko, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian, Kazakh President Kassym-Jomart Tokayev, Chinese President Xi Jinping, Kyrgyz President Sadyr Japarov, Russian President Vladimir Putin, Sharif, Tajik President Emomali Rahmon, Uzbek



President Shavkat Mirziyoyev and SCO Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure chief Ularbek Sharshhev.

Later in the day, Sharif himself shared the complete image. And just like that, the diplomatic photo album received its director’s cut. A summit about big issues-and one very small crop.... The 26th SCO summit was hardly a gathering designed for photographic theatrics. The meeting focused on regional security, economic

cooperation, connectivity and geopolitical challenges, while also marking 25 years of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation.

The expanded “SCO Plus” format brought together leaders from member states as well as partner and observer countries, giving the gathering a broader platform for discussions on regional and international affairs. Among the major issues was terrorism-an especially sensitive subject in South Asian diplo-

macy. Speaking at the summit, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi argued that countries must confront terrorism collectively and without selective standards. He called for dismantling what he described as the wider ecosystem that sustains terrorism, including its financing, recruitment, radicalisation and safe havens. Modi also stressed that nations that use terrorism as an instrument of policy, or provide support and shelter to terrorist groups, needed to face a clear international message. While leaders were discussing security, connectivity, trade and diplomacy, the photograph unexpectedly became its own international talking point.

The episode offered a wonderfully modern lesson in political communication: sometimes the picture you crop becomes more interesting than the picture you were trying to promote.

The original image was a routine summit photograph. The edited version, however, invited questions about why certain leaders had been removed and why Sharif’s position had been preserved.

No diplomatic communi-qué was required. No emergency press conference was necessary. The missing leaders simply reappeared.

In the age of smartphones and instant screenshots, apparently even a family photograph now comes with fact-checking.

For Sharif’s media team, the incident may have been intended as a harmless presentation. But online, it became a reminder that when leaders gather for diplomacy, the cameras are not the only things watching.

And if there was a lesson from the SCO photo saga, it was perhaps this:

You can crop a photograph. You cannot crop the internet.

Delhi Zoo seeks mate for Jatayu after two decades



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Zoo’s lone Egyptian vulture Jatayu, which has spent more than two decades without a mate, will finally have company, with authorities in talks with two zoos in other states to find a suitable pairing for the ageing bird.

Jatayu was rescued after it migrated to Delhi and was brought to the National Zoological Park more than 20 years ago. Since then, it has been the only Egyptian vulture housed there as other inmates died due to age- and health-related issues. According to a Delhi Zoo official, discussions are currently underway with two zoos for a possible pairing for Jatayu. However, the process is still in a preliminary stage, and the zoo has not disclosed the names of the institutions being considered for the proposed arrangement.

“Talks are on with two zoos for the pairing,” he said, adding that they would be able to share details only after the proposed transfer or exchange is formally worked out. He said that the zoo is also looking at conservation facilities in Pinjore, Haryana, where officials are scheduled to visit on September 6 to understand the ongoing vulture breeding and conservation programme. The vulture breeding and conservation centre at Pinjore has been working on conservation breeding of critically endangered Gyps vultures

and has also undertaken programmes to release captive-bred birds into the wild. The facility is jointly run by the Haryana Forest Department and the Bombay Natural History Society.

Egyptian vultures generally begin breeding at around four to five years of age and form long-term pair bonds. They typically lay one egg per breeding season, with both parents involved in incubation and raising the chick.

The species can live for around 25 years in the wild and potentially longer in captivity, allowing individuals to remain reproductively active for several years.

The official said birds and other animals cannot simply be brought to the zoo from such facilities and are acquired through established mechanisms such as animal exchange programmes or gifts. Any vulture brought to Delhi would therefore have to come through one of these approved arrangements.

Jatayu is not the only one. The National Zoological Park is seeking partners for 16 species represented either by lone individuals or same-sex groups, with some animals having remained without mates for several years, as part of efforts to boost breeding and introduce fresh bloodlines.

The zoo’s two male ostriches, both around seven to eight years old, have been without female partners since they were brought from Chhatbir Zoo in 2021.

Raut questions Govt over inflation, unemployment

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Mumbai

Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Sanjay Raut on Tuesday sought to know from the Central Government why inflation and unemployment were rising despite the country clocking a 7.8 per cent GDP growth rate.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday applauded the country’s people for the 7.8 per cent GDP growth rate, calling the feat particularly impressive, coming against the backdrop of global turmoil, geopolitical conflicts, and supply chain disruptions.

In a video message on



Instagram, the PM also slammed those spreading “jhooth ki goonj” (an apparent riff on Rahul Gandhi’s ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ campaign), saying the latest GDP growth rate tore through the narrative of “pessimism” about the Indian economy.

Sitharaman meets Qatar Finance Minister on G20 sidelines

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ Washington

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman met her Qatar counterpart Ali bin Ahmed Al Kuwari, who appreciated India’s strong and resilient growth performance amid ongoing global economic uncertainty.

Sitharaman met the Qatar Finance Minister on the sidelines of the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors (FMCBG) Meeting, in Asheville, on Monday.

“HE Ali bin Ahmed Al Kuwari appreciated India’s strong and resilient growth performance amid ongoing global economic uncertainty,” the Finance Ministry said in a post on X. Al



Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman meets with Qatari Minister of Finance Ali bin Ahmed Al Kuwari on the sidelines of the G20 Finance Ministers and Central Bank Governors (FMCBG) meeting in Asheville, North Carolina, USA

PTI

Kuwari also invited Sitharaman to attend the 11th Annual Meeting of the Board of Governors of AIIB, to be held in Doha later this month.

He said Qatar looked forward to India’s continued engagement for a successful and substantive meeting.

The two leaders discussed the strong strategic partnership between India and Qatar and ways to further deepen economic cooperation, including trade and finance, investments, energy cooperation, the India-Qatar Joint Task Force on Investments, infrastructure including shipping, ports and logistics, advanced manufacturing, and people-to-people contact.

CM to release Godavari water to north Andhra on Wednesday

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Amaravati

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu is scheduled to release Godavari River water to the North Andhra region on Wednesday through the Polavaram Project Left Main Canal, constructed at a cost of around ₹4,000 crore.

The CM will welcome Godavari water by offering a traditional ‘Jala Harathi’ at Payakaraopeta in Anakapalli district on Wednesday, an official release issued on Tuesday said. “The CM will switch on



the regulator constructed across the canal and release Godavari water towards North Andhra,” it said.

The Godavari water will undertake a journey to reach the people of North Andhra, passing through the Pampa, Tandava, Varaha and Sarada rivers, navigating the Yeleru

canal and passing through complex structures carved across the Eastern Ghats. Through Polavaram Project’s Left Main Canal, the water will initially benefit 2.87 lakh acres across four districts and meet the drinking water needs of 5.23 lakh people.

The southern state has spent ₹4,192 crore in constructing the Left Main Canal until now, said the press release. To carry the river across natural barriers, the Water Resources Department has constructed a series of syphons and aqueducts at different river crossings, said the press release.

India is world’s best location to set up data centres: Goyal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal on Tuesday held a meeting with stakeholders of the data centre industry and discussed ways to further promote ease of doing business for the sector.

“We did a round table discussion with stakeholders related to the data centre industry on ease of doing business to promote data centres in a big way because undoubtedly, India is the world’s best location to set up data centres,” he told reporters after the meeting here. The minister said that the data centres, semicon-



ductor industries, artificial intelligence, and the increased manufacturing base are all elements that will power India’s growth in the years to come and take it to greater heights and help the

country achieve a \$30 trillion economy by 2047.

“Nothing less than \$200 billion can be seen coming into the data centres industry,” he said.

Participants, including

hyperscalers, international investors and Indian companies that are looking to invest in the sector, indicated that huge potential is there in the country to attract investments in the segment.

“We are proud of the people of India who, even in these very unnerving and difficult times, with two wars raging and global uncertainty and volatility, have given India 7.8 per cent growth in the quarter from April to June 2026,” Goyal said.

Taking a jibe at the Congress over its criticism of the data, Goyal said, “Angoor khatte hain, mujhe lagta hai.”

“I think it is the same system that has been preparing this data for years. I think

it is an insult to the people of India who are working hard and achieving such fabulous results,” the Union minister said. The Congress on Tuesday termed the latest GDP numbers released by the government as “statistical gymnastics” and said the Make in India initiative has achieved very little, but the Modi government’s signature “Fake in India” scheme continues unabated.

He said that this is not an attack on the government, but on the wisdom, hard work and sincerity of 1.4 billion Indians. “It is their (Indian people) capability and hard work that are making India’s economy grow rapidly,” he added.

FROM PAGE - 1

while the figure had fallen sharply by 2024.

The proceedings began after a two-member NCLT bench comprising Ashok Kumar Bhardwaj, Member (Judicial), and Reena Sinha Puri, Member (Technical), delivered a split verdict on the repayment proposal. The matter was then referred to a third member, whose decision to allow recovery of about ₹6.5 crore from Chandra’s personal eState was challenged by the dissenting creditors before NCLAT.

“It is manifest that as per section 419(5) of the Companies Act, there is no clear majority view capable of being given effect to. Therefore, the order dated 25th August, 2026 of the third member, Shri Nilesh Sharma, Member (J) is stayed,” the bench said on Tuesday.

Chandra, once one of India’s most prominent business figures, built interests spanning television, packaging, infrastructure and direct-to-home television. He was also elected as a Rajya Sabha Member of Parliament on the backing of BJP. His business empire came under severe pressure following the 2018 liquidity crisis, which erupted after the collapse of infrastructure financier IL&FS. Essel Group companies, which had accumulated substantial debt, struggled to refinance their obligations as funding conditions tightened.

Mamata kin dies, probe underway

Nihar Mukherjee had previously served as the Trinamool Congress president of Rampurhat-I block. “Bristi”’s body has been sent for post-mortem examination to the Rampurhat Government Medical College and Hospital. An investigation is underway. The circumstances leading to the death will be established after the post-mortem and other procedural inquiries,” he said.

Family members said Bristi Mukherjee had been suffering from depression and taking medicines for the past few years.

They also said she had been under considerable personal and professional stress. Mukherjee had lost her Group C job at Bolpur High School following a court order that can-

celled recruitments in government-aided schools over alleged irregularities in the selection process during the previous TMC regime, the family members said.

The woman was also going through a divorce proceeding, which had added to her distress in recent months, her family members said.

“Mukherjee was found hanging in a room. A white dhoti was found tied to the ceiling fan, with the other end around her neck,” one of her family members said.

Another relative said, “Bristi used to stay alone in her room and did not talk much with us. None of us saw her outside in the last few days”

The police registered a case of unnatural death and questioned the family members as part of the investigation.

“It could be a case of suicide. An investigation has been launched to ascertain the exact cause of death. No conclusion would be drawn about the circumstances of the death until the post-mortem and other aspects of the probe were completed,” another officer said.

SC invokes special powers to scrap FIRs...

The bench also directed that similar FIRs in other States and Union Territories — other than Delhi, Bihar, Maharashtra, West Bengal and Assam — shall not be pursued or investigated, meaning they shall be considered closed for all intents and purposes.

The bench, however, allowed Delhi Police to pursue the FIR against 2,873 individuals who were present at the Jantar Mantar protests, citing their serious criminal antecedents.

During the hearing, the Union Government proposed registration of a single, fresh FIR against those persons. “Such an FIR can be registered without prejudice to the rights of the affected parties to seek remedies available to them in law, and strictly confined to the two categories of allegations referred to in paragraph 4, namely, bodily harm and destruction of property,” the court said.

Dealing with the award compensation to the families of those who committed suicide, the Bench directed the Government to formulate a pan-India

policy on the issue and pay the money within three months to aggrieved families. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Union Government and Delhi Police, also informed the SC that the Government remained committed to fulfilling all three assurances given to CJP leaders.

Earlier, Delhi police filed an affidavit in the top court seeking quashing of 13 FIRs against students who participated in the protests and registering a fresh case against 2,873 individuals. The application said that according to the decision taken by the Central Government on July 25, Delhi Police no longer wished to pursue the 13 FIRs.

Ram temple trust moves to name new CEO

Committee secretary Sameer Panda said the process used both technology and manual review, and was meant to be thorough and transparent.

The committee used a 600-mark Google Form to score applicants on experience, management skills, language ability, and vision. 108 candidates scored 470 or higher. After four days of virtual interviews, 16 to 17 people were invited to Ayodhya. Sixteen attended closed-door interviews lasting over an hour each on August 11 and 12, after touring the temple complex.

Three more vacancies arose after trustee Vimalendra Mohan Pratap Mishra passed away. The names for two trustee positions and the general secretary’s office may also be announced at the same meeting.

The trust is also expected to confirm Jagdish Aphale as secretary to manage daily administration. The CEO will report to the Trust board and is expected to improve accounts, pilgrim management, security, and long-term planning at a site visited by millions of devotees. Trustees present when the report was received on Tuesday included Swami Govind Dev Giri, Mahant Dinendra Das, interim general secretary Krishna Mohan, and Ayodhya District Magistrate Shashank Tripathi. It is up to the Trust to decide whether to announce the name right after Wednesday’s meeting or wait a bit longer, sources added.

At SCO, PM demands end to terror havens

The PM also flagged drug trafficking as a growing threat to the younger generation and regional security, calling for stronger cooperation among SCO countries to tackle narcotics and organised crime.

“The centres being established under the SCO to tackle challenges such as security threats, organised crime, information security, and narcotics are a positive step. We must make these effective instruments of practical coordination and timely action,” PM Modi said.

On connectivity, PM Modi said India supported efforts to link markets, facilitate trade and create new pathways for development but stressed that such initiatives must respect the sovereignty and territorial integrity of all nations.

The PM also outlined “opportunity” as the third pillar of India’s approach to the SCO, saying the benefits of cooperation must directly reach citizens.

“The third pillar is opportunity. This means that the benefits of SCO cooperation must reach our people directly. Our greatest asset is the bond between our people,” he said.

“For India, the SCO is a confluence of great civilisations, cultures, and ideas. In the SCO’s next twenty-five years, people-to-people ties must remain at the heart of our cooperation,” the PM said.

He said the success of SCO cooperation should ultimately be measured by the opportunities it creates for young people, entrepreneurs and farmers and its impact on people’s lives.

During the family photo session, PM Modi was seen briefly exchanging words with Xi and Putin. PM Modi and Xi were seen shaking hands and speaking briefly before the leaders posed for the group photograph, while Sharif was later seen approaching Putin.

On the sidelines of the two-day summit, PM Modi also held bilateral meetings with Pezeshkian and Putin on Monday. A bilateral meeting between the PM and Xi, however, is unlikely.

MCA probe flags forged DGCA NOC by drone federation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA) inspection report has recorded serious allegations concerning the affairs of Drone Federation India (DFI), including the alleged submission of a forged No-Objection Certificate (NOC) purportedly issued by the Directorate General of Civil Aviation (DGCA).

According to the inspection report, MCA Assistant Director Altaf M Shaikh recommended penal action against three DFI directors and company secretary Anoop Kumar Pandey under Sections 448 read with 447 of the Companies Act, 2013, in connection with the alleged document.

The report followed DFI's application to change its name from "Drone Federation India" to "Drone Federation of India." The proposed name had reportedly faced an objection because it could suggest government patronage. DFI subsequently submitted a purported DGCA NOC as part of the process.

The inspection report states that DGCA informed MCA that the NOC was not genuine and that the file number mentioned in the document did not exist in DGCA records. It further records that the signature on the NOC was attributed to an officer who had retired before the date appearing on the document.

On pages 59-60 of the inspection report, the officer

records that the allegedly false DGCA document was submitted with RUN applications and concludes that the three directors and company secretary were liable for penal action under Sections 448 read with 447.

The Pioneer has accessed the Ministry of Corporate Affairs investigation report.

The report also records a separate alleged irregularity involving a director's signature on a clarification letter. According to the findings, the signature was allegedly copied from a Board Resolution, with penal liability recorded under Section 158.

However, documents connected with the subsequent prosecution before the 37th Court, Fort, Mumbai, indicate



a significant difference between the inspection findings and the charges ultimately pursued.

In Special Case No. 578/2026, filed by the Deputy Registrar of Companies, DFI

and directors Rahat Kulshreshtha, Pravin Vinod Prajapati and Vipul Singh are proceeded against under Sections 134(8), 129(7) and 128(6) of the Companies Act. The provisions relate to cor-

porate reporting, financial statements and maintenance of books of account.

The prosecution does not invoke the Sections 448 and 447 provisions cited by the inspection officer in relation to the alleged forged DGCA NOC.

The MCA's subsequent action communication specifically directed the Registrar of Companies to proceed on Parts B and C of the inspection report, while the alleged forgery finding appears in Part A.

The apparent difference has become a subject of CVC Complaint No. 16240/2026, which alleges that officials failed to act on the Part A findings and raises allegations of possible corruption. The allegations contained in the com-

plaint have not been established.

The matter also comes amid separate scrutiny of the DGCA by the Central Bureau of Investigation in two corruption cases in 2026, including cases involving former Director of Flying Training Capt. Anil Gill and serving Deputy Director General Mudavath Devula over alleged bribery linked to drone-import approvals.

Those cases are independent of the DFI matter and do not establish wrongdoing by DFI or its directors. However, the combination of the MCA inspection findings and the subsequent prosecution has raised questions about regulatory transparency and the manner in which serious findings are carried forward

into enforcement proceedings.

The unresolved issue remains why the alleged forgery finding recorded in the MCA inspection report and accompanied by a recommendation for penal action did not form part of the subsequent prosecution under the same provisions.

On the serious allegation, DFI president Smit Shah issued a statement and said: "The matter is currently sub judice, and we categorically deny any wrongdoing. Our legal team is examining the matter and will respond appropriately before the competent forum. Given the ongoing proceedings, it would not be appropriate for us to comment further at this stage."

MP Guv denies sanction to prosecute Vijay Shah

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bhopal

Madhya Pradesh Governor Mangubhai Patel has reportedly approved the State Cabinet's recommendation against granting prosecution sanction to senior minister Kunwar Vijay Shah over his controversial remarks in May 2025 concerning Army officer Colonel Sofiya Qureshi.

The development came hours after the State Government informed the Supreme Court that the Special Investigation Team (SIT) had completed its probe and that the decision on prosecution sanction rested with the Governor. The Supreme Court subsequently deferred further proceedings, awaiting the decision of the competent authority.

The matter was heard by a bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant and comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and J. Mohana. Additional Solicitor General KM Nataraj, appearing for the state government, told the court that the SIT had concluded its investigation. An SIT



MP Governor Mangubhai Patel, MP minister Kunwar Vijay Shah



officer informed the bench that a chargesheet would be filed if prosecution sanction was granted, while refusal of sanction would result in a closure report.

The Cabinet's recommendation was placed before the Governor on Monday, following which the proposal against granting prosecution sanction was approved.

The Cabinet had decided on August 25 not to grant sanction. The recommendation was then forwarded to the Governor. The entire Council of Ministers is learnt to have supported Shah, a prominent tribal leader of the BJP, with ministers reportedly citing his repeated public

apologies for the remarks.

The controversy erupted on May 11, 2025, when Shah made remarks at a public programme in the Mhow area that were perceived as referring to Colonel Qureshi, who had briefed the media during Operation Sindoor along with Wing Commander Vyomika Singh and Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri. The remarks triggered widespread criticism.

The Madhya Pradesh High Court took suo motu cognisance of the matter on May 14, 2025, and ordered registration of an FIR. Police registered the case at Manpur police station in Indore-Rural under Sections 152, 196(1)(b) and 197(1)(g) of the Bharatiya Nyaya

Sanhita. The High Court also criticised the drafting of the FIR and indicated that it would monitor the investigation.

Shah subsequently approached the Supreme Court challenging the High Court's intervention. On May 19, 2025, the apex court granted him interim protection from arrest and ordered a three-member SIT headed by senior IPS officers to investigate the matter.

The SIT later sought prosecution sanction under Section 196(1)(a) of the BNS. Its report and sanction request had remained pending with the State authorities since August 19, 2025. The Supreme Court subsequently expressed concern over the delay and, on January 19, 2026, directed the State Government to take a decision.

The issue resurfaced before the apex court on May 8, with the bench seeking clarity on the pending sanction. During Monday's hearing, senior advocate Maninder Singh, appearing for Shah, urged the court to consider the minister's apologies and representation while deciding the matter.

Congress, JMM protesting MMDR Act to divert people's attention from students' movement, says Jharkhand BJP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Ranchi/Jamshedpur

Jharkhand BJP chief Aditya Sahu on Tuesday alleged that the Congress and the JMM were protesting against the MMDR Act to divert people's attention from the students' movement against alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations in the State.

He said that the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Act, 2026, is in the State's interest.

"The Congress and the JMM are engaged in political posturing over MMDR and misleading the public to divert attention from the students' movement. The MMDR Act is in the State's interest," Sahu said in a statement.

He said the Act will help curb illegal mining.

"Both the ruling parties should not be under the illusion that their protest against MMDR would make the students' issues disappear (from the public eye).



Jharkhand BJP chief Aditya Sahu

pear (from the public eye).

"The students' protest would continue till their demand for a CBI inquiry into irregularities in recruitment exams is met. The Congress-JMM's protest (against MMDR) is not for protecting mineral resources but to shield the masterminds behind the recruitment examination scams," Sahu alleged.

Parliament in August passed the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026, which seeks to restrict states' powers to levy taxes

on mineral rights and mineral-bearing lands.

Questioning the CID probe into the alleged examination irregularities, Sahu alleged that the government's actions regarding the investigation were failing to progress beyond newspaper headlines.

"Students and job aspirants across the state are consistently raising questions regarding transparency in recruitment exams, timely appointments, and their own future. But the State Government is evading

these fundamental issues. This is an attempt by the ruling dispensation to divert the course of the student movement," he said.

The BJP stood by the students in their struggle for justice and will continue to stand firmly in the future as well, he added.

Reacting to Sahu's statement, JMM central general secretary Vinod Kumar Pandey accused the BJP of indulging in politics over students' issues.

"The concerns raised by the JMM and the Congress regarding the MMDR are not politically motivated. They represent a fight for the state's constitutional rights over its water, forests, land, and mineral resources," he said.

Pandey said the BJP does not have the right to decide on issues the ruling parties will raise.

Meanwhile, former Jharkhand chief minister Champai Soren questioned the JMM-led government's intention in opposing the MMDR Act.

Punjab CM Mann calls for massive awareness drive to curb stubble burning

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chandigarh

Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Tuesday called for a multi-level information and awareness campaign to curb the burning of paddy straw in the State.

He also claimed that due to the State Government's sustained efforts, there was 86 per cent decline in such incidents from 2023 to 2025.

Directing officers to take the campaign deep into villages and blocks, CM Mann stressed that active participation of NGOs, social workers, panchayats and farmers, backed by large-scale social media outreach and stronger ex-situ and in-situ paddy straw management, is essential to consolidate these gains and protect Punjab's environment.

Chairing a meeting on the paddy straw management strategy, Mann stated that around 30 lakh hectares of paddy has been sown in Punjab this year, which is expected to generate 18.81 million tonnes of paddy straw.

"Due to the strenuous efforts of the Punjab government, Punjab has witnessed 86 per cent reduction in stubble fire incidents from 2023 to 2025, he said.

The incidents have come



down from 36,663 in 2023 to 10,909 in 2024 and further to 5,114 in 2025. We have to take this progress further and ensure that stubble burning incidents are reduced even more this year, he said.

Calling for an intensified grassroots campaign, Mann said, "A massive information and awareness campaign must be launched at the village and block levels to make farmers aware about the hazards of paddy straw burning. Every stakeholder must work together to motivate farmers to adopt sustainable alternatives to stubble burning."

He said NGOs and social workers should be actively involved in the campaign to strengthen efforts to motivate farmers.

"NGOs and social workers

should be roped into motivating farmers. Machinery demonstrations, nukkad natak, meetings with sarpanches, pledge-taking activities and other awareness programmes must be organised extensively so that the message reaches farmers at the grassroots level," he said.

Mann also called for a comprehensive digital and multi-media strategy to complement field-level activities.

"A detailed digital plan should be implemented covering radio jingles, print media, television, mobile SMS and outdoor media. The social media awareness campaign should also be conducted on a big scale to create wider awareness about the harmful effects of paddy straw burning and the available management options," he said.

West Bengal Govt imposes fine on public spitting, littering

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

When in the City of Joy, spit, pee or poo on thoroughfares at your own peril. This is because the Bengal Government started cleanliness rules from Tuesday, with civic authorities in Kolkata and other municipal areas cracking down on violators for spitting, soiling, urinating in public or even disposing of plastic in undesignated places.

Civic inspectors were doing the rounds and were parked at public places, corners, markets, transport hubs and elsewhere to spot offenders and impose instant fines that would not be accepted other than through digital means. "No cash is



Representative image

accepted... only you have to pay digitally," said an official of the Kolkata Municipal Corporation, which was presently run by an Administrator.

"You cannot do whatever you like on the streets and public places... there has to be some kind of civic discipline that should be followed by the members of the society... if offenders do not

see reasons in following civic

rules then they will have to be given a lesson or two on cleanliness through imposing penalty... there is a price you have to pay for everything," Bengal Municipal Affairs Minister Agnimitra Paul earlier said.

"From 1st September, let's say NO to single-use plastic. Say no to plastic bags, cups, straws and disposable

cutlery. Together, let's protect our environment and build a cleaner, greener Bengal for the next generation," Paul posted while her party colleague and senior BJP leader and former MP Lockett Chatterjee said, "cleanliness is not the responsibility of the Government alone... the people should also learn to cooperate."

To begin with, the Government had fixed Rs 100 as a fine for those who spit in public places, including schools, markets, hospitals, etc while one will have to pay ₹200 for urinating or defecating in the open other than designated public toilets. For using banned plastic too, one will have to pay ₹200 digitally.

Littering, depositing, dumping or throwing any solid waste, plastic waste, garbage, debris or other waste material in public streets, roads, drains, water bodies, open spaces or any place other than designated waste collection points, and the use or carrying of banned plastic carry bags in violation of applicable laws and Government orders too will attract a penalty.

The new rules also target illegal parking and encroachment, while charges will be introduced for night-time roadside parking in urban areas.

This apart, the mandatory use of Bengali as the language for official communication and orders also started from Tuesday.

Suwendu announces health, pension benefits for mediapersons

SAUGAR SENGUPTA
■ Kolkata

Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari on Tuesday fulfilled his earlier promise by introducing a host of schemes and programmes for the benefit of journalists and common people, including providing health insurance to the media personnel and launching a specialised disaster management force



christened Arjun Vahini to be recruited preferably from the defence personnel, including the (retired) Agni

Veer jawans.

Accordingly, the Chief Minister doubled the pension benefits for the retired journalists from ₹2,500 to ₹5000 besides bringing them into the Chief Minister's health insurance scheme. Accordingly, the journalists would benefit from the Mukhyamantri Swasthya Bima Yojana by getting free medical treatment up to ₹5 lakh in designated 38,000 Government

and private hospitals across India, including AIIMS, Christian Medical College (CMC)-Vellore, Tata Cancer Hospital in Mumbai, PGIMER-Chandigarh, and Dr Reddy's Hospital in Hyderabad.

In West Bengal, the facility would be available in 1900 state and private hospitals. While the scheme was available only to Accredited journalists earlier, it would benefit other media men too, officials said. As for

pension, the journalists in districts would get ₹3,000 per month in place of earlier ₹1,000.

Regarding 'Arjun Vahini', the Chief Minister said that the Force would presently comprise 200 personnel to begin with and later the number of the staff would be increased adding, "priority of appointment would be given to the former defence personnel including the (retiring) Agni Veers."

Bihar power minister invites investors, highlights solar plan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Bihar Power Minister Shailesh Kumar alias Bulu Mandal on Tuesday invited national and global investors to partner in the State's rapid economic and energy growth, assuring them of full administrative support and an enabling environment.

Addressing the inaugural session of 'Bharat Electricity 2026' on the theme Energy Sovereignty for a Climate-Resilient Viksit Bharat, the Minister showcased Bihar's modernised power sector. He

inaugurated the Bihar Power Pavilion, highlighting the State's strides in clean energy, storage systems, and digital grid transformation.

Kumar revealed that Bihar has installed over 94 lakh smart prepaid meters, successfully reducing Aggregate Technical and Commercial (AT&C) losses from around 60 per cent to 11.54 per cent. He added that the State recently met a record peak demand of 9,475 MW, with projections expected to touch 19,033 MW by FY 2037.

Outlining upcoming initiatives, the Minister announced



Bihar Power Minister Shailesh Kumar

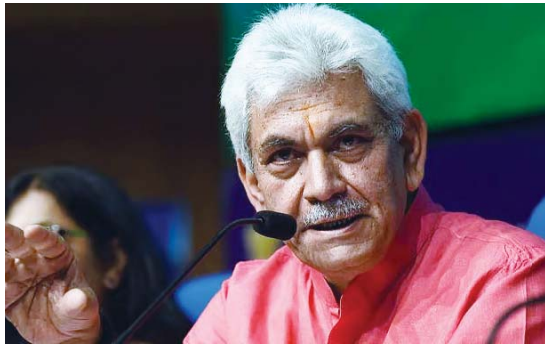
a scheme to provide free 1.1 kW rooftop solar systems to 2.5 lakh Below Poverty Line (BPL) families in the coming months. Key future projects highlighted at the pavilion included a 1,200 MW Pumped Storage Plant at Nawada, major solar-plus-storage

setups in Lakhisarai, and initial discussions on nuclear energy options.

"Come to Bihar not merely as investors, but as our partners. Our goal is to ensure every consumer becomes energy sovereign," Kumar stated, emphasising the need for climate-resilient infrastructure to withstand natural calamities like floods and storms.

Senior officials, including Delhi Power Minister Ashish Sood and Central Electricity Authority Chairman Ghanshyam Prasad, attended the event.

States Focus



MAINTAIN PRESSURE ON TERROR NETWORKS: J&K LG TO OFFICIALS

Lieutenant Governor Manoj Sinha on Tuesday instructed senior officials to maintain pressure on terror networks, enhance ground-level operational synergy to eliminate emerging threats. Emphasising that public trust is vital to the security apparatus, Sinha directed police officials to foster engagement with the public, designate specific hours for citizen interaction and grievance redressal.

"Police must continuously engage with the public. Every genuine grievance must be addressed with sensitivity and every investigation must be conducted with fairness and transparency" he said. While reviewing security situation and assessing the security apparatus and strategic preparedness across the UT, he underscored transparent, impartial and sensitive complaint handling. (PTI)



CEC GYANESH KUMAR TO VISIT GOA TO ENGAGE WITH BLOs

Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar will arrive in Goa on Wednesday for a two-day visit to interact with booth-level officers and engage with youth as part of measures to strengthen electoral participation at the grassroots, officials said on Tuesday. Goa is slated to go to polls in 2027.

During his visit, Kumar will also attend a regional conference on Electoral Literacy Clubs (ELCs) and the ECINET platform at Ravindra Bhavan in Margao, South Goa, the Chief Electoral Officer, Goa, stated in a release.

He will interact with BLOs on Wednesday, providing them an opportunity to share their experiences. (PTI)

Rahul should apologise for spreading falsehood on Indian economy: BJP

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The BJP on Tuesday hailed Prime Minister Narendra Modi's leadership for the 7.8 per cent GDP growth in the April-June quarter and demanded that Congress leader Rahul Gandhi apologise for calling the Indian economy "dead" and spreading falsehood that a big economic tsunami was on its way.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters here, senior party leader Ravi Shankar Prasad also lauded Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman's financial management and the contributions of the Indian industry, businessmen and workers for the achievement.

He slammed the Congress for its criticism of the Modi Government's economic policies, saying, "We have brought the Indian economy from the fragile five in 2013 to 7.8 per cent GDP growth."

Crediting Prime Minister Modi's vision and leadership, Prasad hit out at Gandhi, alleging that he tried to tarnish India's image with his baseless remarks about the



BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad

Indian economy.

"Rahul Gandhi has shared a wealth of insights over the past three or four months: 'Indian economy is a dead economy, a big economic tsunami is coming'. Now, a growth rate of 7.8 per cent is there in front of you. Do you have some shame?" the BJP MP asked the Congress leader.

"The BJP condemns outright the irresponsible, false, baseless and mischievous contention of Gandhi that the Indian economy is a dead economy and a big economic tsunami is going to come," Prasad said

This has happened despite war and the Gulf crisis. This

happens when there is stable leadership in the country like Narendra Modi, who can turn challenges into opportunity. This happens when the entire country stands together with Modi's leadership, the BJP leader said

Prasad said that though Gandhi is the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha, he is bereft of any understanding of economic management and economic development.

"The BJP demands that Gandhi must apologise for condemning the Indian economy based on falsehood and baseless allegations that it is a dead economy and a

big economic tsunami is coming," he added.

"Rahul Gandhi doesn't do his homework. He relies on cheat-speak. He simply reads out whatever has been written for him," the BJP leader said, and asked, "Has Rahul Gandhi taken a contract to compromise and weaken the morale of the people of India?"

Prime Minister Narendra Modi has termed the GDP growth a "herculean feat", calling it particularly impressive, coming against the backdrop of global turmoil, geopolitical conflicts and supply chain disruptions.

In a video message on Instagram, the prime minister also slammed those spreading "*jhooth ki goonj*", an apparent riff on Rahul Gandhi's "*Chhatron ki Goonj*" campaign, where he has been critical of the Modi Government's performance, saying the latest GDP growth rate tore through the narrative of "pessimism" about the Indian economy.

Modi said India must maintain the growth momentum and continue working towards greater self-reliance.

Rahul slams ECI, BJP after over 2 crore voters excluded from Maharashtra voter roll



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

With more than 2.06 crore electors excluded from Maharashtra's draft electoral roll after the SIR exercise, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday alleged that the BJP and the "Vote Chori Aayog" keep changing their tactics and will continue to do so as their goal remains to ensure the BJP's victory at any cost.

Gandhi said that for a Government built on 'vote chori', the people are not important and that is why the BJP neither listens to the people nor obeys their command.

"The BJP and the 'Vote Chori Aayog' keep changing their tactics, and they will continue to do so - the goal remains just one: BJP's victory at any cost, and the end of India's democracy," the Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha said in a post in Hindi on X.

More than 2.06 crore electors, accounting for 21.14 per cent of Maharashtra's previous voter base, have not figured in the draft electoral roll following a Special Intensive Revision (SIR), the Chief Electoral Officer said on Monday.

The draft roll currently has more than 7.71 crore voters (78.86 per cent of the previous electorate), comprising 3.95 crore men, 3.75 crore

women, and 3,087 third-gender voters, according to State election authorities.

As many as 2,06,88,487 people have not been included, as their enumeration forms were uncollectable because they were either untraceable, deceased, or had shifted residences, they said.

Reacting to the development, Gandhi said, "Maharashtra 2024— Suddenly, 39 lakh new voters were added between the Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha elections. I said it then, and I say it today: This was vote theft."

"Bengal 2026 — Of the names struck off in the SIR, 91 per cent had to be reinstated after appeals. That means 9 out of every 10 names were wrongly deleted, and added back only after the election. I said it then, and I say it today: This was vote theft. And now in Maharashtra, 2.07 crore voters have been removed from the draft list - that's every fifth voter," Gandhi said.

"Lok Sabha 2024: 9.29 crore; Vidhan Sabha 2024: 9.7 crore; SIR 2026: 7.78 crore. Which list was correct? For a Government built on vote theft, the people are not important - that's why this BJP neither listens to the people nor obeys their command," the former Congress chief said.

BJP launches 10-day *Padayatra* against alleged corruption in Karnataka Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Raichur (Karnataka)

The Opposition BJP in Karnataka on Tuesday kick-started a 10-day '*Padayatra*' from Raichur to Ballari to protest against the alleged corruption under the Congress Government in the State.

The BJP targeted Chief Minister DK Shivakumar for re-inducting Ballari Rural MLA B Nagendra in the cabinet, who they alleged was involved in the ₹89 crore scam in Karnataka State Maharshi Valmiki Scheduled Tribes Development Corporation.

Nagendra had resigned as Tribal Development Minister in June 2024 when the scam came to light following the suicide of a corporation official



Karnataka BJP President BY Vijayendra, State Assembly LoP R Ashoka, former state CM BS Yediyurappa and others during the inauguration ceremony of the Ballari Chalo Padayatra in Bengaluru

PTI

cial P Chandrasekharan, who left behind a detailed suicide note. He was re-inducted on August 3.

The opposition party had disrupted the legislative session, demanding Nagendra's removal. The din compelled assembly speaker GS Patil and legislative council chairperson Saleem Ahmed to adjourn the pro-

ceedings of the Houses sine die on August 24, cutting it short by three days.

Senior party leaders, including three former Chief Ministers – BS Yediyurappa, Basavaraj Bommai and Jagadish Shettar, led the agitation at Lingasugur in Raichur district.

Addressing the gathering, Yediyurappa termed the

Padayatra a protest against the "power drunk" Congress Government.

"This Government, which is drunk on the power of its mandate, is anti-farmer, anti-people, anti-environment, anti-women and involved in corruption. Our struggle will continue until this Government is removed," Yediyurappa said.

He asked Shivakumar whether he has any freedom at all because he has to run to Delhi for every issue.

"If you have to go and bow at Rahul Gandhi's feet for everything, are you really the Chief Minister? Are you doing anything that brings dignity to the office of Chief Minister? The people of the state are watching all this," the BJP stalwart in Karnataka said.

ZSI scientists, global experts come across new species of deep-sea skate

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata

Scientists from the Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), in collaboration with ICAR-Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI) and international experts, have discovered a new species of deep-sea skate in the Arabian Sea off India's southwestern coast, an official said on Tuesday.

The discovery was made during surveys carried out under the Ministry of Earth Sciences Deep Ocean Mission, aimed at studying and documenting little-known marine life in India's deep waters.

A deep-sea skate is a flat, shark-related fish that lives on the dark bed of the ocean.

The new species, commonly called the Arabian skate, can grow up to about 1.3 metres in length and was found at depths of 400 to 600 metres off the Kerala coast and in the Wadge Bank region.

Scientists identified the skate as a distinct species after examining its physical features and conducting



Zoological Survey of India

genetic studies. One of its most noticeable features is five rows of thorn-like structures along its tail, a ZSI spokesperson said Tuesday.

Genetic testing also showed that the Arabian Skate is different from its closest known relative, the Travancore Skate, with the two species showing a genetic difference of around 3.8 to 4.7 per cent.

The species had remained unidentified for more than four decades and was earlier mistaken for another type of deep-sea skate. It has also frequently been caught as bycatch in deep-sea shrimp trawling operations.

The scientists have named the new species after Dr Dhriti Banerjee, the first

woman Director of the Zoological Survey of India, in recognition of her contribution to research on India's biodiversity. "The deep sea remains largely unexplored, and every survey provides a crucial opportunity to expand our understanding of marine biodiversity," Banerjee said.

Banerjee further said deep-sea skates are particularly vulnerable to overfishing because they generally reproduce slowly, have few offspring and take a long time to recover when their populations decline. "Identifying these species before their populations decline is essential for developing effective, targeted conservation strategies," she said.

India faces rise in fatty liver, colorectal cancer

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

India is seeing a rise in gastrointestinal diseases such as fatty liver and colorectal cancer, experts said on Tuesday, highlighting the need for greater focus on their early detection and prevention.

Ahead of the World Congress of Gastroenterology (WCOG) 2026, experts from AIIMS, Delhi, said improvements in hygiene, vaccination and public health measures have helped reduce several communicable and preventable diseases, but the country is now witnessing a growing burden of metabolic and lifestyle-related gastrointestinal conditions.

The World Congress of Gastroenterology (WCOG) 2026, which will be held for the first time in India from September 30 to October 3 at Yashobhoomi in Dwarka, will bring together gastroenterology experts from across the world to discuss the changing burden of digestive diseases.

Dr Pramod Garg, professor and head of the Department of Gastroenterology and Human Nutrition at AIIMS,



Representative image

said, "India is facing an epidemiological shift at this time. We have made significant strides in controlling preventable disease through awareness, vaccinations and improving quality of life, however alongside these we are now seeing metabolic disease on a scale we have never handled before."

Fatty liver disease has emerged as a major concern, with an AIIMS-led systematic review and meta-analysis finding the condition in 38.6 per cent of Indian adults and 35.4 per cent of children, said Dr Shalimar, professor in the department of Gastroenterology at the hospital said.

The disease is closely associated with diabetes, obesity

and hypertension and can remain silent until liver damage has progressed, he said.

According to experts, India is facing a rise in the form of metabolic conditions such as fatty liver disease and colorectal cancer alongside persistent infections such as Helicobacter pylori and intestinal worm infestations.

A recent study has also reported clinically significant liver fibrosis in one in four patients with Type 2 diabetes

India included fatty liver disease in its National Programme for Prevention and Control of Non-Communicable Diseases in 2021, followed by guidelines

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Raipur

The Enforcement Directorate on Tuesday conducted searches at multiple locations in Chhattisgarh, including against a former personal assistant of ex-chief minister Bhupesh Baghel, in a money laundering probe linked to alleged irregularities at the State Public Service Commission, officials said.

They said a total of seven locations in Bhilai, Durg and Raipur are being raided as part of the probe initiated under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA).

The investigation pertains to alleged irregularities at the Chhattisgarh Public Service Commission (CGPSC) and the searched premises include that of KK Chandrakar, the former personal assistant of Baghel,



the officials said.

Baghel had earlier dismissed allegations made by the ED in the liquor and coal levy-linked money laundering cases, calling the charges a political witch hunt against him and people linked to him.

The money laundering investigation stems from a Chhattisgarh EOW FIR and a subsequent complaint filed by the CBI in July 2024.

The CBI case was filed after the BJP defeated the Congress party and came to power in Chhattisgarh in November 2023.

Taman Singh Sonwani, a former Chairman of the PSC, was arrested by the central agency in July as part of this investigation related to alleged corruption, question paper leaks, and manipulation of the CGPSC conducted state service examinations.

for its detection at the primary-care level.

"The disease is easy to find if we look for it, and we become aware only after the patient falls ill. This is a greater challenge than before — we must move away from only treating diseases; we must now actively promote good health," Dr Garg said.

Colorectal cancer is another growing concern, with doctors reporting an increasing number of cases among younger adults. India recorded 40,430 new cases among men and 24,433 among women in 2022, according to available data.

Blood in the stool, persistent changes in bowel habits and unexplained weight loss should not be dismissed as routine gastrointestinal problems, experts said.

"India has never been short of gastroenterologists or technology. What we have lacked is the habit of taking early symptoms seriously," said Dr Govind Makharia, professor at AIIMS and chairman of the local organising committee for WCOG 2026.

"Any symptom that persists beyond two to three weeks should be evaluated," he said. Persistent infections also

remain an important part of India's gastrointestinal disease burden. H pylori, which is associated with peptic ulcer disease and gastric cancer, remains widespread, while intestinal worm infections continue to affect children and can contribute to anaemia and undernutrition.

At the same time, conditions such as celiac disease and inflammatory bowel disease (IBD), once considered uncommon in India, are increasingly being recognised.

A community-based study led by AIIMS found celiac disease in approximately one in 96 people in northern India. "Inflammatory bowel disease and celiac disease were textbook rarities in India when I trained, and we now see them every week," said Dr Vineet Ahuja, professor at AIIMS and secretary general of the Crohn's Colitis Foundation of India.

The WCOG 2026 will focus on advances in diagnostics, endoscopy, therapeutics, gut microbiome research and artificial intelligence-enabled healthcare, besides examining the changing global burden of gastrointestinal diseases.

Editor's

TAKE

The Russia embrace, recalibrated

As the two leaders reaffirmed their commitment to a relationship tested by war and sanctions, India made clear that its ties with Moscow remain important

When Narendra Modi and Vladimir Putin embraced on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Bishkek on August 31, it was the image both governments wanted the world to see: warm and familiar, unbothered by the past year's turbulence.

Their bilateral meeting – the first face-to-face encounter since Putin's visit to New Delhi last December – was brief by diplomatic standards, but its symbolism travelled further than its substance.Modi's message was carefully calibrated. "We must move away from endless war towards an end to the war," he told Putin, adding that "every day spent in war sets humanity back." It was a restatement, four years on, of the line he delivered at Samarkand in 2022: "today's era is not an era of war." Putin, for his part, reached for language both sides have used since 2010, calling the relationship a "special and privileged strategic partnership," and thanked Modi for his "personal attention" to it.

Modi used the occasion to invite Putin to New Delhi in September for the BRICS summit, keeping the calendar of contact dense even as the war in Ukraine grinds on. The meeting is being called significant less for what was announced than for what it confirmed: that Washington's year-long campaign to prise India away from Moscow has not worked as intended. Donald Trump's decision last August to push tariffs on Indian goods to 50 percent, explicitly citing its Russian crude purchases, was the most direct pressure an American president has applied to India's Russia policy in decades.

Tariffs came down again in February after signals that Indian refiners would scale back, and imports did fall for much of the last fiscal year. But the rebound has been telling: Russian crude buys climbed again this spring, pushing bilateral trade up more than 50 percent for the quarter, oil doing almost all the work while Indian exports stay barely visible on Russia's books.That imbalance is the honest picture of where the relationship stands today.

Two decades after Moscow was India's default partner on everything from fighter jets to nuclear plants, the tie is now narrower and more transactional: discounted crude and fertiliser, spares and maintenance for a legacy defence inventory built around the S-400 and Soviet-era platforms, safer rupee-rouble payment channels to dodge sanctions, and a \$100-billion trade target both sides keep restating without a credible path there. Where this heads will be decided as much in Washington and Beijing as in Moscow or Delhi.

India's simultaneous thaw with Xi Jinping at the same summit – itself partly a by-product of Trump's tariffs – gives New Delhi more room to treat Russia as one hedge among several, not a pillar.

Moscow, meanwhile, has grown steadily more dependent on Beijing, leaving it less able to reciprocate India's balancing act than before. The Bishkek embrace was genuine enough. But it described a friendship being managed in a crowded field, not one being restored to the centre of India's foreign policy.

The American dream, under a visa siege

Despite the tightening of visa rules – and even as courts push back against some of the administration's measures – the pull of the American Dream remains remarkably strong



KALYANI SHANKAR

The Trump administration aims to reform the immigration system and tighten immigration rules. As part of this, it plans to pause certain immigration visas and pause visa processing. During his second term, the Trump administration has paused or rescheduled visa appointments at US embassies and consulates worldwide. This affects individuals seeking to travel to the US for work, study or family visits.

The administration aims to cancel B1/B2 visas for 200,000 asylum seekers. Since taking office, it has cancelled over 175,000 visas for foreign citizens for a variety of reasons, according to the State Department. This visa pause impacts 75 countries.

The suspension of specific visa categories has created challenges and uncertainty for many foreign nationals, particularly those from India. This decision has raised concerns for families, workers and students who rely on these visas for various opportunities in the United States.

However, last week, the US resumed issuing immigrant visas to people from 75 countries after a long pause. This change followed a federal court ruling against the visa pause, which began in January to screen applicants who might require more public benefits in the US. This is part of a larger plan to train diplomatic staff globally to enhance the efficiency and effectiveness of US diplomatic operations.

Currently, nearly one million Indians are stuck in the US employment-based green card backlog, representing about 79 per cent of those awaiting approval in the first three categories. An analysis by the National Foundation for American Policy suggests that Indian nationals filing applications in January 2026 or later could face waits of 179 years for EB-2 and 38 years for EB-3 permanent residence.

This is part of a larger plan to train diplomatic staff at posts worldwide. The goal is to make US diplomatic operations more efficient and effective.

The administration is also cracking down on birth tourism, where foreign pregnant women travel to the US to give birth, thus gaining birthright citizenship for their children. Trump has tried to end this practice; however, the courts, including the Supreme Court, have consistently rejected his efforts.

The State Department has announced modifications to visa appointment schedules to support consular officer training. This



THE SUSPENSION OF SPECIFIC VISA CATEGORIES HAS CREATED CHALLENGES AND UNCERTAINTY FOR MANY FOREIGN NATIONALS, PARTICULARLY THOSE FROM INDIA. THIS DECISION HAS RAISED CONCERNS FOR FAMILIES, WORKERS, AND STUDENTS WHO RELY ON THESE VISAS FOR VARIOUS OPPORTUNITIES IN THE UNITED STATES

The writer is a popular columnist

training aims to help officers better identify visa applicants who may rely on US public benefits and ensure a thorough, consistent evaluation of all visa applications.

The US visa system plays a crucial role in enabling international travel, work, study and family reunification. The government has temporarily paused processing certain visa types, including Temporary Work Visas (H-1B), student visas (F-1) and family-sponsored visas, as part of efforts to improve visa management. This is a challenging time for many individuals from India and other countries, and these changes are expected to streamline the process moving forward.

Students planning to study in the US are feeling the impact of this uncertainty regarding their visa status, which complicates their enrolment in academic programmes and may force them to re-evaluate their educational plans entirely. The ongoing suspension of visa processing is causing significant issues for families. Many Indian nationals have relatives in the United States waiting for green cards or other immigration assistance, leaving these families uncertain and facing both emotional and practical challenges.

Maintaining familial connections across international borders is difficult, especially during significant life events. India is currently facing major challenges due to recent changes in US policy.

Other nations, such as China, Mexico and the Philippines, which have many citizens living in the United States, are also affected by these changes. As globalisation con-

nects economies and cultures, these policy changes could significantly impact international relations and economic cooperation.

There is a growing call for immigration reform. As people and families navigate this uncertainty, they need robust policies and support systems more than ever.

Immigrant rights advocates and other organisations are working to improve the US visa process. They aim for the government to recognise the challenges individuals and families face and create easier pathways to obtain visas.

Additionally, the Trump administration plans to revoke the visas of approximately 200,000 foreigners who entered the country for tourism or business but sought to extend their stay by applying for asylum.

Earlier this week, the Trump administration began reviewing a new proposal to overhaul the H-1B visa programme, signalling another potentially significant change to the employment route used by thousands of Indian professionals. This proposal could impact the US economy by at least \$100 million annually.

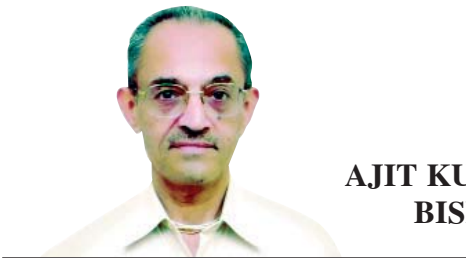
Ongoing advocacy and reforms are essential to ensure that the immigration system meets the diverse needs of individuals seeking opportunities in the United States.

Recently, US courts have limited some of the Trump administration's measures, including a federal judge's ruling that overturned a previous decision. But all these have not made the aspirants pull back or stop; they continue towards the completion of their "American dream".

PIC TALK



A worker sorts jute fibers from harvested stalks near a waterbody, in Nadia district, West Bengal, PHOTO: PTI



AJIT KUMAR BISHNOI

2ND OPINION

Yes, I am referring to the famous verse 2.47 of the Bhagavad-Gita. There are four instructions in this verse. The first instruction is: "You have a right only in action." Lord Krishna is talking about what we do with our mind, words and body. In the spiritual language, these must be our duties, including to self as a soul, to family, nation, etc. And the right is what is within our control as a soul. We can act as we wish, exercising our free will, but the result is not in our hands.

Recently, I was faced with a serious problem; our company's income tax return had come under scrutiny. We were asked to submit supporting evidence of the expenses, and they gave a date by which to submit them. It was a monumental task of transmitting all the expense vouchers. We consulted tax experts. They all



advised taking their shelter and, of course, giving a very fat fee to manage this problem. After giving the matter serious thought, we decided to take the pain part; we began transmitting the information sought by them. To cut a long story short, we managed to transmit all the supporting evidence, as sought by the tax authority. Still, the result was not in our hands, whether they would be satisfied or not. To the relief of all and surprise of the so-called tax experts, we got a no-dues acknowledgement. This brings us to the second instruction of Lord Krishna,

which is: "Not ever in determining its fruits/result." The question naturally arises, then, about who decides the results. The answer lies in the 'Karmaphala Principle', which is: "What you sow is what you reap." God has set up a Divine Authority under His superintendence to shoulder the responsibility of deciding the results of our 'karmas' (deeds). They take all relevant factors into consideration and decide. Therefore, all decisions are, in effect, made by God only.

And God is perfectly just in awarding them. The result belongs to the person concerned, and no one else; he must get it. A wrong impression is prevalent that the fruits of our acts don't belong to us. This is farthest from the truth. God does not need these fruits. Doesn't He own everything? What happened in the income tax scrutiny? We exercised our right to act, and the result was given to us. We had also obeyed Lord Krishna's instruction of not trying to manipulate the fruit of action. And we also did not disobey the Lord's fourth instruction: "Your attachment to inaction also should not be there." We painstakingly did our duty.

The conclusion is: We all have a right to do our duties, which is the only right we have. Results are not in our hands. We should do our duties, and neither try to manipulate the results nor be inactive. Then, we will be rewarded suitably; we can be sure of it; God has arranged it.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and columnist

STRONG GDP GROWTH MUST TRANSLATE INTO INCLUSIVE PROSPERITY

India's 7.8 per cent GDP growth in the first quarter of 2026-27 is welcome news at a time when the global economy faces geopolitical disruption, uncertain trade policies and volatile energy markets. The outcome reflects the underlying strength of domestic activity rather than mere statistical comfort. Manufacturing expanded by 9.2 per cent, construction by 7.7 per cent, and financial, real-estate, IT and professional services by 12.1 per cent. These figures show the beneficial effects of public infrastructure spending, improving industrial activity, credit availability and sustained demand for services. However, celebration should not turn into complacency. Agriculture grew only 3.6 per cent, while mining contracted. Any weather disruption later in the year could weaken rural incomes, farm output and food-price stability. Further, higher crude-oil prices,

conflict-linked supply disruptions, a weaker rupee and protectionist trade measures can enlarge India's import bill, revive inflation and hurt exports. Growth led by capital-intensive sectors and government-supported construction must be accompanied by enough productive, formal and adequately paid jobs. Private investment needs to broaden beyond a few sectors and large companies.

The policy task, therefore, is to protect macroeconomic stability while sustaining public capital expenditure and encouraging private investment. Better farm productivity, urban employment, skilling, export competitiveness and targeted support for MSMEs would make growth more inclusive and resilient. This will also help sustain investor confidence, protect household purchasing power and support stronger growth over time.

BAL GOVIND | NOIDA

Please send your letter to the info@dailypioneer.com. In not more than 250 words. We appreciate your feedback.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Haldwani narrative undermines its credibility

Apropos, "BJP slams Rahul Gandhi over Haldwani FIR row," The Pioneer, Sep 1. The Congress party's mounting desperation was clearly on display in Haldwani. Allegations by AICC President Mallikarjun Kharge and Rahul Gandhi — claiming right-wing activists performed a "purification ritual" to humiliate Kharge — are a blatant political attempt to target the BJP. Organisers at Haldwani's Ram Lila Maidan clarified that the ritual was purely symbolic. It was conducted to clean a venue left littered and polluted by hostile speeches and slogans during the event, with no casteist intent whatsoever.

Yet, Congress deliberately twisted this factual response into a narrative of untouchability to manufacture outrage. This tactic follows a clear pattern of a struggling party relying on false claims for electoral gain. In today's era of live streaming and instant checks, the public cannot be easily misled. By repeatedly pushing false and divisive caste rhetoric, Rahul Gandhi is not winning over voters. Instead, he is damaging his own credibility and exposing his strategy to the nation. Such conduct only deepens public scepticism and weakens Congress's credibility further ahead of future elections.

N SADHASIVA REDDY | BENGALURU

Messi bids international football goodbye

To the surprise of everyone, legendary football player Lionel Messi announced his retirement from international football last Monday. Messi made the official announcement on Instagram, confirming his decision to retire from Argentina's national team at the age of 39. From an accolade-decorated career to winning the World Cup, such a farewell is obviously hard to accept for his worldwide fan community.

Messi is not a champion for Argentina alone; he is a global star, with 125 goals in 207 games for the national team and a FIFA World Cup victory in 2022, Argentina's first in 36 years. Although this was Messi's second such publicly claimed retirement after 2016, his departure from international football will undoubtedly be an emotional moment for millions of fans worldwide. As global admirers of his remarkable career, his adieu from the game is definitely a hard goodbye. We hope that younger generations will cherish Messi's achievements, learn from his playing spirit and artistry, and carry his legacy forward in international football in the future. His journey will remain an inspiration for aspiring footballers across the world. His name will forever be remembered among the greatest to have played the beautiful game.

KIRTI WADHAWAN | KANPUR

Indus Waters Treaty needs a rethink

Apropos the news report 'India rejects Indus water ruling' (September 1), the Permanent Court of Arbitration's order on the Indus Waters Treaty raises important questions about the limits of international arbitration and India's sovereign rights. India's rejection of the ruling is understandable, particularly because New Delhi has consistently maintained that the court was constituted in violation of the treaty's provisions. The larger issue, however, is the future of the Indus Waters Treaty itself. Signed in 1960, the treaty has survived wars and prolonged hostility between India and Pakistan. Yet Pakistan's continued support for terrorism and its use of international forums to challenge India's hydropower projects have altered the strategic environment.

India's decision to keep the treaty in abeyance sends a clear message that agreements cannot be treated as one-sided obligations when broader relations have deteriorated. At the same time, New Delhi must ensure that its actions remain technically, legally and environmentally defensible. Water is a strategic resource, especially for Jammu and Kashmir. India should therefore pursue its legitimate rights under the treaty while accelerating hydropower development and maintaining diplomatic pressure on Pakistan.

VANDANA | CHANDIGARH

YSR’s legacy lives on: Jagan’s journey from welfare to empowerment

Seventeen years after the untimely death of YS Rajasekhara Reddy, his political legacy continues to be defined not merely by welfare schemes but by a larger idea of governance: that social justice must translate into tangible economic security, opportunity and dignity



APPALA RAJU SEEDIRI

the largest in the social sector, and every family claimed him as their own.

During his gruelling padayatra, he comprehended the needs of the common person. Farmers, women, youth, Backward Classes, the socially disempowered, and the economically vulnerable formed his foremost concern.

With these sections in mind, his government discarded the World Bank’s conservative playbook and came up with sweeping reforms across the power, agriculture, public health and higher education sectors. It is worth mentioning some of his salient schemes as we observe his anniversary today. The first government order he signed was to provide free electricity for agricultural use.

The second major relief measure that he extended to the farming community was to waive agricultural loans. He initiated massive irrigation schemes that changed the landscape of agriculture in the Telugu states and ensured that farmers had constant access to water throughout the crop seasons.

His Aarogyasri was India’s first public health insurance scheme, which ensured that the health needs of every vulnerable family were covered. He instituted the historic post-matric fee reimbursement scheme that provided every student with the government’s financial backing to pursue higher education.

The Backward Classes form the bulk of our state’s population. To reduce them to a mere social category does injustice to their massive contribution to our economy. They are our farmers, weavers, fishermen, potters, masons, small traders, skilled workers, artisans and those who form the service backbone of our society and economy.

When YSR assumed the stewardship of the state in 2004, Andhra Pradesh was not a welfare state. For the preceding nine years, the state, which was governed by the rulebook of neoliberal economics, withdrew from providing direct relief to its citizenry.

Recognising that social justice should not be limited to an abstract constitutional promise but must be anchored in material security and institutional access, he took up a slew of welfare measures.

For him, welfare was never charity but a precondition on which a state could promise its citizenry opportunities that would lead to upward social mobility. Thanks to the policies listed above, within the span of a generation, millions of families from otherwise socially vulnerable and economically deprived sections emerged empowered out of debilitating poverty.

When the YSRCP formed its government in Andhra Pradesh in 2019, our leader Jaganmohan Reddy believed that carrying forward his father’s legacy required a clear three-pillar approach to the empowerment of the Backward Classes: Welfare, Development and Leadership.

Our government provided direct support to BC households and traditional occupations. YSR Cheyutha provided 75,000 over four years to eligible women from BC, SC, ST and minority communities. YSR Nethanna Nestham ensured handloom weavers received 24,000 annually.

YSR Matsyakara Bharosa strengthened assistance to fishermen and offered financial support during those periods when fishing was banned. Through YSR Vahana Mitra, we provided financial succour to auto, taxi and maxi-cab driver-owners, while Jagananna Chedodu assisted tailors, Rajakas and Nayee Brahmins.

YSR Aasara provided relief to members of self-help groups and waived outstanding loans.

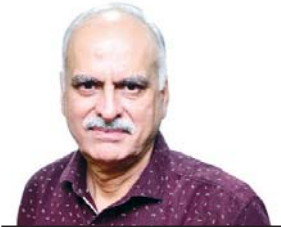
For the first time in the state’s political history, we created 56 corporations that addressed the needs of 139 communities that are listed under the Backward Classes.



HIS AAROgyASRI WAS INDIA’S FIRST PUBLIC HEALTH INSURANCE SCHEME, WHICH ENSURED THAT THE HEALTH NEEDS OF EVERY VULNERABLE FAMILY WERE COVERED. HE INSTITUTED THE HISTORIC POST-MATRIC FEE REIMBURSEMENT SCHEME THAT PROVIDED EVERY STUDENT WITH THE GOVERNMENT’S FINANCIAL BACKING TO PURSUE HIGHER EDUCATION.

OUR LEADER MR JAGANMOHAN REDDY’S PADAYATRA TAUGHT HIM THAT ECONOMIC ADVANCEMENT WITHOUT POLITICAL POWER IS INCOMPLETE. HE DECIDED TO CREATE A NEW GENERATION OF ORGANIC LEADERSHIP BY TRANSFORMING THE BACKWARD CLASSES FROM A VOTE-BANK TO DECISION-MAKERS

The writer is a former Minister for Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairy Development, Government of Andhra Pradesh



ANIL ANAND

to become proactive, impressively and daringly raising political and societal issues. And above all, managing to establish a connect with the younger generation, or Gen Z, who have steadfastly stood behind Prime Minister Narendra Modi during the last one decade. Squatting on a dharna outside Parliament Street Police Station in support of a pellet-injury-hit youth is the latest in the series of steps in this direction.

The contrast between Gandhi’s high-profile individual outreach and the perception of a sluggish Congress party stems from deep structural decay, heavy reliance on a top-down (mostly defunct) leadership model, and disconnected regional hierarchies. When high-visibility campaigns fail to translate into organised local momentum, it exposes a disconnect between national optics and ground-level execution. This has repeatedly happened, but there is no attempt to learn lessons and set the house in order.

Despite his sensible interventions and thoughtful suggestions on vital national and international issues, Gandhi gives an impression of still being a loner in the GOP’s vast spread all over the country. That is strange enough. But why so? Does he himself need to reflect or change his approach towards the organisation by shrugging off indecisiveness? Shouldn’t he adopt a proactive approach to set the party and its leaders right, as he has been doing in his solo efforts? Firstly, he must follow the dictum suggested by none other than Gandhi himself. Pick up the right person for the right job with a strong rider of accountability. He needs to do this in the light of his observation that the party has been putting up the racing horse on the job to pull a cart and vice versa. Even before that, while on a visit to Gujarat, he had spoken about the BJP sleeper cells active in the state Congress (that scenario prevails in many states and Union Territories) and the need for heads to roll. It has been months now, but the follow-up action is still to come. The BJP and regional parties’ sleeper cells are thriving all over the Congress network.

An immediate follow-up action on such counts would have given Gandhi a decisive edge and created deterrence, thereby making it easier for him to tone up the organisation. Indecisiveness has portrayed his weakness; this attitude has emboldened those becoming roadblocks for the party to act more vigorously in internal sabotage. Indecision, reluctance to take hard decisions and the tendency to protect even the “failed horses” under the garb of being favourites of someone have become the Congress’s bane. It is hard to believe that Gandhi and other leaders are not aware of this malady. What is intriguing is that they are knowingly allowing such a situation to prevail at a greater cost not only to the party but to the nation as well, as it weakens the position of the country’s main premier opposition party in the overall democratic context.

A strong reason behind Gandhi’s “loner status” is that leaders around him in the AICC and PCCs have found a convenient way to shrug off their responsibilities and justify inaction by seeking refuge under the leader’s umbrella. “Rahul Gandhi naraz ho jayen ge (Rahul Gandhi will get annoyed)” is their usual refrain to justify not taking a decision in any particular situation. For instance, how could it be justified that it takes months, sometimes years, to make organisational changes at the AICC or the PCCs level? It is criminal negligence; firstly, a non-performing leader is allowed to continue and, secondly, the organisational set-up is given to him/her at a time when a change should have been effected, as a reward for non-performance.

A case in point is the sensitive and strategic Jammu and Kashmir, where Congress, being a national party, other than the ruling BJP, has an important role to play but is being prevented from doing so by organisational shortcomings which the high command refuses to remove. On the occasion of PCC president Tariq Hamid Karra completing two years in office, despite all the controversies he has courted due to his “style of functioning” and total lack of connect with the rank and file, the AICC in-charge Syed Naseer Hussain rushed to Kashmir to work on providing a new organisational set-up to him as a reward. This happened in the backdrop of a controversy germinating from Karra’s alleged non-appearance at the Independence Day function held at the party office.

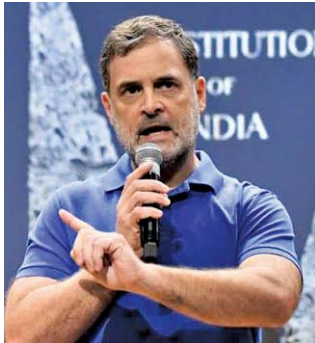
Shouldn’t completion of two years in office have been a stocktaking time, with Karra asked to present his report card? For that reason, any AICC or state/UT functionalities? Appointment or continuation in office shall be directly related to the performance of the incumbent, which should be the thumb rule from AICC down to PCCs.

Such a scenario prevails in many other states and UT units, with no sense of accountability attached anywhere. Apart from the states/UTs, another weak link is the nonchalant attitude of some top AICC office-bearers, particularly those made in charge of the states and UTs. In the absence of accountability, they are merely living in comfort zones, at times becoming Gandhi’s cheering brigade. This has become a convention, to be seen to be on his right side.

How best to use the services of ageing and well-entrenched regional and a set of national-level leaders is a daunting challenge for Gandhi, as these leaders are making the generational transition difficult. To tackle this situation, he needs to have a set of well-versed and trusted advisers rather than acting solo, which will also help in lessening over-reliance on brand Gandhi.

A classic case of this syndrome is at play in yet another sensitive border state of Punjab. The old guard in the state is feverishly working unitedly to thwart generational change, which has come in the form of Rahul Gandhi-loyalist PCC chief Amrinder Singh Warring, who, like Karra, has also completed two years in office. Serious factionalism has risen ahead of the 2027 Assembly elections. No doubt the old guard is taking undue advantage of the situation, but it is also a reflection on Warring’s functioning and ineffective handling by the central leadership. Such situations can only be tackled through quick and tough decisions. No matter if it involves removing a so-called loyalist in the overall interest of the party, as is the case in Jammu and Kashmir and Punjab.

The writer is a political analyst



When algorithms enter the field: What AI means for India’s small farmers



NEHA SEHRA | REETA SONY

While sowing, a farmer in India checks an agri-tech app that advises him to delay planting due to an expected dry spell. The advice is based on satellite imagery, historical rainfall data and machine learning models. But the rain arrives earlier and more heavily than predicted. The sowing window is lost, along with the seeds and other resources the farmer has invested. Stories like these are increasingly common as farmers rely on predictive tools and artificial intelligence (AI) to guide agricultural decisions. These technologies are promoted as one-stop solutions to climate uncertainties, stagnant yields and distress in the agriculture sector. Algorithm-based advice is presented as “informed decision-making”, influencing everyday decisions and raising a question: who benefits from agricultural algorithms and who should be held responsible when their predictions go wrong?

With advances in science and technology, agricultural practices have evolved. Traditionally, agriculture relied on human labour, animals and

knowledge of soils, seasons and risks. This was Agriculture 1.0, marked by modest productivity and dependence on traditional knowledge. Production increased sharply in the 19th and 20th centuries with Agriculture 2.0, driven by mechanisation and chemical fertilisers. But this came with a high ecological cost: greater dependence on agricultural inputs, falling groundwater levels and soil degradation. Information and communication technologies entered farming in the late 20th century, marking the advent of Agriculture 3.0. Precision farming, automated machinery and satellite monitoring became more common, while chemical use could be reduced. This paved the way for Agriculture 4.0, where data, algorithms and predictive models are increasingly used. AI systems use data from soil sensors, drones and weather forecasts to advise farmers on when to sow, irrigate, fertilise and harvest. Farming that once relied largely on experience is now increasingly guided by prediction.

India’s shift towards digital agriculture is driven by climate change, unreliable monsoons, extreme weather and pressure on limited land and water. Predictive analytics and AI tools are promoted as scientific solutions to raise farmers’ incomes, reduce climate risks and use resources efficiently. But agriculture is shaped by social, ecological and socio-political conditions, which AI cannot always capture. Predictive technologies run on data collected through mobile applications, sensors and other tools. This includes soil properties, crop images, yield patterns, weather records and farmer behaviour. Farmers generate this data con-



tinuously, often without realising it.

Farmers have less control over data generated from their fields. Most agri-tech firms, insurance providers and input suppliers have unclear data policies, offering little information on how data is stored, shared and utilised. Data collected from millions of farmers becomes a valuable asset for these firms, while farmers seldom benefit from it. Data-driven systems can influence farmers’ access to credit, insurance payouts or government schemes. This imbalance reduces farmers to data profiles rather than decision-makers. As knowledge moves from the soil to servers, authority shifts from those who work in the field to distant digital systems.

Predictive technologies rely heavily on past data to identify patterns and project them into the future. But climate change has unsettled these models. Erratic rains, prolonged heatwaves, unseasonal storms and shifting pest cycles mean historical data is less reliable. Most Indian farmers depend on rain-fed agriculture, where predictions

may fail to capture local differences. Yet digital advisories continue to be issued, leaving farmers to choose between the algorithm and their own experience. When predictions fail, the cost falls most heavily on smaller farmers, who are least able to bear the losses.

For generations, Indian agriculture has drawn on indigenous practices, community experience and ecological knowledge. AI systems, however, tend to favour data that can be measured and standardised, often overlooking local knowledge. Their advice may ignore differences in soil, cropping patterns and household circumstances.

This can sideline effective local practices and reinforce farming methods that depend heavily on external inputs. Farmers may feel pressured to follow these recommendations rather than adapt them to local conditions or learn from others in their communities. Over time, this could weaken their independence and increase reliance on software and off-farm inputs. Technology, therefore, does more than support farming. It can shape what counts as agricultural knowledge, how it is tested and how much value is placed on it.

One of the most critical concerns with introducing AI into agriculture is responsibility. Suppose an algorithm’s advice leads directly to crop failure; who should be held accountable - the app developer, data provider, government bodies promoting these platforms, or the farmer who acted on the suggestion? At the moment, there is little clear guidance. Most digital tools in agriculture lack systems for handling complaints or established rules about liability. Farmers are urged to trust

these systems, but when they fail, responsibility scatters and accountability goes missing.

Without transparency and safeguards, these technologies can shift the burden of managing uncertainty from institutions to individual farmers.

AI and predictive technologies are not inherently problematic. If developed and used responsibly, they can improve decisions, reduce physical burden and make better use of scarce resources. But they should support, not replace, farmers’ judgement and local knowledge. Data governance must recognise farmers’ rights over their data, backed by genuine consent and transparency. Public platforms and open systems can also provide an alternative to the growing dominance of private firms in agricultural data.

These technologies should also be part of wider efforts to promote climate-resilient and agroecological farming. They cannot be treated as miracle solutions to long-standing agrarian problems.

The future of Indian agriculture will depend not only on technology but also on the values and institutions shaping its use. Predictive tools can either deepen existing inequalities or help build fairer and more sustainable farming systems. The question is not whether India should use AI in agriculture, but how it is used and in whose interest. Without accountability, farmer participation and respect for ecological realities, “smart farming” may fail those who need it most.

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Order Order

HC asks Govt to respond to MP's plea against FB page suspension

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday sought responses from the Union Government and Meta Platforms on a plea by National Conference MP Aga Syed Ruhullah Mehdi challenging the suspension of his Facebook page. Justice Swarana Kanta Sharma issued notice and asked the Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, and Meta Platforms, which owns Facebook, to file their replies.

The court, which listed the plea for a hearing on September 30, refused to grant the Lok Sabha MP any interim relief at this stage and said it would not pass any order without hearing the other side. During the hearing, the counsel for Meta Platforms submitted that the MP's Facebook page was taken down pursuant to a law enforcement agency's notice and sought time to present the court with relevant documents.

The petition said Mehdi, a Lok Sabha member, is also a religious leader and has a Facebook page titled 'Ruhullah Mehdi' which serves as a primary medium for disseminating information, engaging with constituents, and participating in democratic dialogue. However, the petitioner's access to the social media page has been restricted by Meta since March, at a notice issued under the Information Technology Act. The petition, filed through advocates Tamanna Pankaj and Archit Krishna, said Meta took the action without providing the petitioner any opportunity of hearing, nor were any detailed reasons disclosed to him. The counsel said Mehdi sent a representation to the grievance redressal officer, and Meta was required to respond within 24 hours, but no reply came. "The statutory framework permits the removal or disabling of access to specific unlawful content upon due process; however, it does not contemplate or authorise a blanket restriction on an entire account or page without identifying specific offending material and without adherence to the limitations prescribed under Article 19(2) of the Constitution of India," the plea said. It said Mehdi's Facebook page constitutes not only an exercise of his right to freedom of speech and expression but also a medium of professional engagement and public outreach. *(PTI)*



SC Collegium recommends new chief justices for multiple HCs



The Supreme Court Collegium, headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, has recommended the appointment of new chief justices for the Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh high courts. The collegium, comprising the CJI and Justices Vikram Nath, B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh and P S Narasimha, made the recommendations at its meeting on Monday. Justice Sanjay K Agrawal, whose parent high court is the Chhattisgarh High Court, has been recommended as the Chief Justice of the Rajasthan High Court. The recommendation for the Rajasthan High Court comes against the backdrop of allegations made by Supreme Court judge Justice Sandeep Mehta against the court's Acting Chief Justice Sanjeev Prakash Sharma.

Justice Mehta, whose parent high court is also the Rajasthan High Court, had written three letters to the CJI on August 2, 10 and 17, urging the appointment of a permanent chief justice from outside the state. The collegium has also recommended Justice Alpesh Yeshwant Kogje of the Gujarat High Court as the Chief Justice of the Madhya Pradesh High Court. Justice Dr Pushpendra Singh Bhati, whose parent high court is Rajasthan, has been recommended as the Chief Justice of the Jammu & Kashmir and Ladakh High Court.

Separately, the collegium, at its meeting held on August 6, recommended the appointment of Justice Krushna Ram Mohapatra, a judge of the Orissa High Court, as the chief justice of the Chhattisgarh High Court. The recommendation was made in view of the retirement of the incumbent Chief Justice on September 4. The recommendations will take effect after the government makes the necessary appointments under the constitutional process. *(PTI)*

SC defers hearing in cash-for-query scam against Mahua Moitra

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday deferred the hearing on two pleas filed by the Lokpal in the alleged cash-for-query scam against Trinamool Congress MP Mahua Moitra.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana took note of the fact that the Centre, which was made a party to the petitions on July 24, was unrepresented during the hearing.

"The Union of India is unrepresented. One more opportunity is granted to the UOI to file the counter affidavit (reply), if required. The matter is adjourned,"

the bench said.

On July 24, the bench had made the Ministry of Home Affairs a party to the pleas.

Prior to this, the top court had on March 13 stayed a part of the December 19, 2025 order of the Delhi High Court permitting the Lokpal to consider granting sanction to the CBI to file a charge sheet against Moitra in the alleged cash-for-query scam.

It had issued notices to Moitra, the CBI and BJP MP and complainant Nishikant Dubey on the Lokpal's pleas against the high court's decision. The Lokpal had challenged the high court's judgement that had held that separate sanctions for the filing of a charge sheet and initiating prosecution

SC closes suo motu case over NCERT chapter on judiciary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday closed suo motu proceedings pertaining to the contents of the class 8 NCERT textbook referring to corruption in the judiciary after it was informed that the chapter was withdrawn.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana took note that the controversial chapter has been replaced based on the revisions suggested by an expert panel constituted by the Centre. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta informed the apex court that the textbooks with the new chapter are in circulation.

The top court also clarified that a statement recorded in its May 22 order, that the curriculum had not been placed before the committee at all levels and therefore could not be termed a collective decision, was only the



submission of Solicitor General Mehta and was neither an observation nor an order of the court.

The solicitor general clarified that he had not accused the academicians of not placing the curriculum before the committees.

"We never said that they had not placed it. I said factually that curriculum was not placed before the committee and therefore it was

not a collective decision," Mehta said.

The clarification came after senior advocate Arvind Datar, appearing for one of the academicians, submitted that the observations, if misconstrued as a judicial finding, will cause prejudice to them.

The bench was hearing a suo motu case concerning NCERT's Class 8 social science book, which contained "offending" contents on cor-

ruption in the judiciary.

The top court had earlier modified its March 11 order that had directed the Centre, states and others to disassociate from three academicians following a row over the controversial chapter on corruption in the judiciary.

The apex court, which considered the explanation given by the three academicians, had left it open to the Centre, states, Union Territories,

public universities and institutions that receive funds from the central or state governments to take an independent decision on the issue without being influenced by its observations made in the March 11 order.

It had also recalled a part of the March 11 order that had recorded that the three academicians – Professor Michel Danino, Suparna Diwakar and Alok Prasanna Kumar – had "deliberately and knowingly" misrepresented the facts in order to project a negative image of the Indian judiciary to the students of Class 8. The bench passed the order while hearing an application filed by the three academicians, who explained their stand and said that no individual had the sole say in the drafting of the content and it was a collective process.

The court had also observed that its comments were made in the context of the contents and not the

individuals.

On March 11, acting tough against the three experts involved in the drafting of the controversial chapter in the National Council of Educational Research and Training's (NCERT) social science book for Class 8, the court had directed the Centre and all states to disassociate from them.

It had directed the Centre to form a committee of domain experts within a week for the purpose of finalising the curriculum of the NCERT's legal studies for not only Class 8 but also higher classes.

On February 26, the apex court imposed a "blanket ban" on any further publication, reprinting or digital dissemination of the NCERT's Class 8 social science textbook that contained the "offending" contents on corruption in the judiciary, saying they have fired a gunshot and the judiciary is "bleeding".

IRS daughter's case: Delhi court frames rape, murder, robbery charges

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

A Delhi court has framed charges of rape, murder and robbery against a former domestic help accused of killing the 22-year-old daughter of a senior Indian Revenue Service (IRS) officer at her south Delhi residence, paving the way for the trial to begin this month.

Additional Sessions Judge Ankit Singla framed the charges against accused Rahul Meena and fixed September 7 for commencement of prosecution evidence. A detailed order is awaited. According to the prosecution, Meena, who had earlier worked as a domestic help for the victim's family, allegedly entered their Kailash Hills residence on April 22 using a hidden key after her parents were away. He allegedly assaulted and raped the woman before



strangling her and fleeing with cash, jewellery and mobile phones.

The 22-year-old, an engineering graduate and UPSC aspirant, was found unconscious by her parents after they returned home. She was taken to a hospital where she was declared dead.

Police have alleged that the accused strangled her with a mobile phone charging cable after sexually assaulting her. Meena was arrested from a hotel in Dwarka on the day

of the incident following a police manhunt. During his initial appearance before a magistrate, he had allegedly told the court that he had "made a mistake" and committed the crime for money.

The police subsequently filed a 493-page chargesheet against Meena, alleging that he was familiar with the family's routine and knew that the victim would be alone at home when her parents went out in the morning.

Assault on doctors in Thane: SC says HC fully justified in taking suo motu cognisance, staying bail

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday said the Bombay High Court was "fully justified" in taking suo motu cognisance and staying the bail granted by a trial court to Shiv Sena corporator Ramesh Mhatre, accused of assaulting doctors at a municipal hospital in Thane district in July.

A bench of justices Vikram Nath, Augustine George Masih and Sandeep Mehta also observed that those attacking doctors do not deserve bail. The observations came from the bench which was hearing the pleas, including the one filed by Mhatre, challenging the orders of the high court.

Mhatre, a corporator of the Kalyan-Dombivli Municipal Corporation (KDMC), has challenged the conditions imposed by the high court while granting bail.

On July 18, taking suo motu cognisance, the high court had stayed the bail granted by the lower court and asked



Mhatre to surrender before the police. Later, on August 7, the high court granted bail to Mhatre and ordered that the trial be fast-tracked and completed in a time-bound manner. The high court had also granted bail to three other accused in the alleged assault case that had triggered a massive outrage.

During the hearing before the apex court on Tuesday, one of the counsel appearing for the petitioners argued that the order passed by the high court on July 18 was

wrong. "This is a case where the high court is fully justified in taking suo motu cognisance and staying the bail," the bench said.

"Those who don't have any respect for people from the medical fraternity, they don't deserve it," it observed.

The bench said that doctors, including a lady doctor, were assaulted and the video of the incident was viral. "Imagine the trauma of the person when a mob attacks. You can go inside a hospital and hit any

random person," the top court asked. The counsel appearing for Maharashtra government said they would also file a petition challenging the grant of bail.

The bench posted the matter for hearing on September 7. On July 6, Mhatre and other accused gathered at the hospital and allegedly assaulted the doctors after an argument over the purported delay in the treatment of a woman patient. The incident took place at Shastri Nagar Hospital after family members of the pregnant woman accused hospital staff of delaying treatment. The court in Thane on July 14 granted bail to Mhatre but the high court on July 18 stayed the order, calling it "perverse". On August 7, the high court granted bail to Mhatre and some other accused in the case and imposed strict conditions on them.

It had also ordered them to stay outside Maharashtra until the chargesheet in the case is filed.

Police can't pick and choose accused to arrest: Delhi HC



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Delhi High Court has deprecated the police for not arresting a nurse, alleged to be the main accused in a 2024 child trafficking case despite the gravity of the offence, asserting police cannot "pick and choose".

Justice Girish Kathpalia, while rejecting the bail plea by a co-accused in the case, observed that the court cannot approve of the State's policy to selectively arrest only some of the accused persons. The present applicant, along with another co-accused, allegedly impersonated as husband and wife when they adopted an infant girl, who was then sold to another co-accused.

He contended that he had been falsely implicated and that the main accused, nurse Kulvinder Kaur, was yet to be arrested. "Of course, the policy of the State to selectively arrest some of the accused persons cannot be approved. The police should clearly state as to whether they want to arrest an accused or not. The court cannot direct the police to do or not to do so. Such kind of pick and choose in matter of arrest must be deprecated," said the court in the order passed on August 31.

The court asked the investigating officer to explain Kaur's status, noting that there was no explanation for

the "selective arrest" of the accused persons involved in the present case, and that police were practically taking no action against her.

The prosecution counsel said Kaur was an "unqualified nurse" and assured that she would be arrested. "It seems that now the State realizes the gravity of the alleged offence. I am of the considered view that merely because for some unknown reason, the police opted not to arrest one of the accused persons, the Court cannot shut its eyes to the gravity of the alleged offence," Justice Kathpalia said.

The court asked the DCP concerned to make sure that the girl child is rescued at the earliest and sought a report in four weeks. The court observed that the material prima facie showed that the infant girl, sixth in her family, was sold by the present applicant as there were photographs showing him accepting her in presence of her biological parents, and he admittedly did not have her custody now. The court emphasized that the infant suffers a "tremendous dent in her psyche" when she is taken away from her biological mother by the adoptive parent, followed further by other persons. While dismissing the bail plea of the applicant, the court said his role is "highly appalling" and it was not a fit case for release from custody.

INTERVIEW



AS INDIANOIL TRANSITIONS INTO A DIVERSIFIED ENERGY MAJOR, IT SEEKS CURIOUS, RESILIENT TALENT TO TACKLE CHALLENGES. EQUIPPING ITS WORKFORCE WITH FUTURE-READY SKILLS LIKE ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE, THE COMPANY OFFERS PROFESSIONALS CAREER GROWTH TO BOARD-LEVEL LEADERSHIP



Powering people, energising the future

As IndianOil prepares for a future shaped by technology, sustainability and new forms of energy, its people strategy is undergoing an equally significant transformation. In conversation with *The Pioneer*, Rashmi Govil, Director (Human Resources), IndianOil, shares her perspective on future skills, AI, emerging career opportunities and what the next generation needs to succeed in India's evolving energy sector

IndianOil is transforming from a conventional oil and gas company into a diversified energy major. How is this transition changing the kind of talent and skills that IndianOil will require over the next decade?

Our current business strategy focuses on strengthening the core while also capitalising on new and diversified business opportunities. Therefore, our talent strategy, which is totally business-aligned, is also focusing on core disciplines while developing the current manpower to handle new business challenges.

To quote a few examples, about three years back, as changes started happening in the energy mix, we launched a programme, "Nav Urja", in collaboration with premium academic institutes of the country, with a customised programme imparting technical and commercial skills required to scale up in the field of renewable energy.

We are also actively equipping our employees with skills in AI, data sciences, biofuels, green hydrogen, etc. Thus, our belief in balancing the inward and the outward helps us keep an equal focus on the existing and the new.

Artificial intelligence, automation and data analytics are rapidly changing the workplace. How is IndianOil preparing its existing workforce for this transformation, and which digital capabilities will become most important for future employees?

The skills mentioned need different degrees of penetration in different work profiles. At the same time, it is also required that some level of expertise in these skills should be available across all job roles. Hence, we are following a

two-pronged approach for imparting these new-age skills. On one side, we conduct a series of webinars and offer several online certification courses to our employees so that a large cross-section of employees has a working knowledge of these skills. On the other hand, we also have specialised courses imparting

sustained deep insight to a limited set of employees who would be driving production and process efficiencies by leveraging AI and data analytics at plant/process/field level.

For students and young professionals who aspire to build a career with IndianOil, what qualities do you look for beyond academic performance and technical qualifications?

We are looking for candidates with a keen sense of curiosity, learning agility, innovation mindset and resilience to accept new challenges that come with postings in new locations and different new assignments. IndianOil has a pan-India presence in the end-to-end hydrocarbon value chain, i.e. upstream, midstream and downstream, and also a whole range of product portfolio. This requires executives to move across multiple job roles and geographies, and thus the said attributes are an imperative for us.

Young professionals today increasingly seek purpose, learning opportunities and rapid career growth. How is IndianOil adapting its employee experience to attract and retain this new generation of talent?

I would say that for any young professional seeking purpose, learning opportunities and career growth, we are a great choice. We grow our own timber. Thus, young professionals who join IndianOil at the

lowest induction level and have the potential and right leadership qualities can grow up to the Board level. In fact, several of our professionals have been selected for Board-level positions in other companies as well.

In addition, as mentioned earlier, our pan-India presence and multiplicity of roles provide a very rounded learning experience and opportunity to challenge oneself throughout the career lifecycle.

We are the "Energy of India" and one of the largest commercial undertakings. Nation-First, Care, Innovation, Passion, Trust are our core values and also our strongest Employee Value Proposition for retention. We take care of our employees from cradle to grave and have low attrition rates. We are a company to build a life-long career with.

Green hydrogen, biofuels, EV infrastructure and other new-energy businesses are opening entirely new career opportunities. Which emerging areas should engineering, management and other students start preparing themselves for today?

While we recruit candidates in core engineering streams and through our HR interventions keep talent relevant across their life cycle, we would certainly want candidates who are aware and have the know-how of the latest in the energy sector. After all, all emerging branches of engineering find their foundation in core engineering disciplines.

As one of India's largest public-sector enterprises, IndianOil offers diverse career opportunities. What advice would you give young professionals seeking to build long-term leadership careers at IndianOil?

Don't think twice. If you have the potential and the drive, with IndianOil, the sky is the limit. Come join us.



From classroom to real-world expertise

JO-ANNE MURRAY

Vice-Principal (Education), University of Aberdeen

Postgraduate education is changing. The traditional view of postgraduate study as simply the next academic step after an undergraduate degree is giving way to a more dynamic model, one that places greater emphasis on application, critical thinking, adaptability and the ability to connect knowledge with the complexities of the real world. This shift is being driven by changes in both the workplace and the people entering higher education. Postgraduate classrooms today bring together students with different academic backgrounds, professional experiences and ambitions. Among them are professionals returning to education after years in industry, bringing with them knowledge developed through managing teams, solving problems, building businesses and navigating change.

They do not enter the classroom as blank slates. Their experiences can become an

important part of the learning process.

The role of postgraduate education, therefore, is not simply to add another layer of theoretical knowledge. It is to create opportunities for students to test experience against theory, question established assumptions and develop a deeper understanding of why particular approaches work, or do not.

This is where critical reflective practice becomes increasingly important.

A professional may have developed an effective way of managing a team or solving an operational challenge. Academic study can provide the frameworks and evidence to examine that experience more critically. What assumptions underpin the approach? What does the research suggest? Could it work differently in another context? Asking these questions turns experience into a source of deeper learning.

This also changes the nature of the classroom. The lecturer remains an important source of academic knowledge and guidance but is not necessarily the only source of expertise. Students bring their own



perspectives and professional experiences into discussions, creating opportunities for academic and practical knowledge to inform one another.

This evolution is also prompting universities to rethink how postgraduate education is designed. For professionals balancing established careers with further study, flexibility and focus are increasingly important considerations. This is one reason more intensive postgraduate formats, including one-year programmes, have gained greater attention in management education.

But the significance of such programmes is not simply their shorter duration. A shorter programme should not mean a smaller intellectual ambition. It should mean that the curriculum, teaching and learning are designed with greater focus around

what students need to achieve.

Ultimately, the question for universities is not how much content can be delivered in a particular period, but how effectively students can develop the ability to think critically, apply knowledge and continue learning beyond the classroom. At the University of Aberdeen Mumbai, this philosophy informs our approach to postgraduate education. We aim to create an academically rigorous environment in which students can connect theory with practice and engage with the challenges facing organisations and society. This is particularly relevant as artificial intelligence, technological change, new business models and shifting expectations of leadership continue to reshape professional life. The ability to learn something new is important; the ability to recognise when existing knowledge needs to be questioned may be even more valuable.

The new face of postgraduate education is therefore not defined simply by who enters the classroom or how long a programme lasts. It is defined by a deeper relationship between experience, academic knowledge and application.

Postgraduate education at its best does not simply certify what a student already knows. It creates the intellectual space to examine that knowledge, challenge it, strengthen it and apply it in new contexts.

The journey from experience to expertise is ultimately a journey from knowing to questioning, and from questioning to learning how to think differently.

How education can bridge disciplines

SANJEEV VIDYARTHI

Provost, Anant National University

The world around us poses increasingly complex challenges. Emergent climate change, rapid urbanisation and frequent technological disruptions present intertwined challenges that rarely fit within the bounds of conventional thinking and certainly exceed the boundaries of any single discipline. Addressing these complex challenges requires future-ready professionals who understand multiple perspectives, are trained to work collaboratively and are able to connect and create knowledge across domains.

This is where the role of interdisciplinary education becomes critical in training professional practitioners capable of understanding, and even shaping, an increasingly complex future.

Traditionally, higher education largely promoted distinct

disciplines, with each branch of knowledge developing specialised literature and expertise. Such specialisations remain important in their own right, but the complex challenges confronting human society today require interdisciplinarity that diligently integrates appropriately selected skills, methods and approaches to develop a more comprehensive and contextual understanding that goes beyond a single field of study. Climate change, for instance, is no longer a matter of environmental concern alone. It has implications for city planning, agriculture, infrastructure, mobility, housing, public health, livelihoods and economic development.

Similarly, developing products and services that respond meaningfully to human needs requires a clever understanding of technology, business, user

behaviour, sustainability and the larger social context of our times. The professional workplace is beginning to reflect this interconnectedness. A diverse range of industries nowadays collaborate with professionals from different disciplines and backgrounds to design better solutions and enhance outcomes. Architects and engineers seek to collaborate with urban, landscape and space designers to create climate-responsive settlements that are more resilient, efficient and inclusive. Tech giants regularly hire trained designers to develop intuitive and user-centric digital experiences.

Emergent AI and other smart digital technologies are changing how products, services, buildings and infrastructure are conceived, evaluated and marketed. Yet, human judgement, contextual understanding and interdisciplinary thinking remain essential to ensuring technology meaningfully responds to people, place and purpose.

Interdisciplinary education helps prepare students for this emerging reality. It enables learners to move beyond traditional academic silos, engage constructively with diverse perspectives and approach problems from multiple vantage points. Complex problems rarely have singular solutions. These require inquiry, collaboration and experimentation.

This has important implications for Indian universities. Interdisciplinary education cannot be achieved by simply placing differ-

ent subjects alongside one another. It requires meaningful collaboration across disciplines, experiential learning, industry engagement and productive opportunities for students to work together on real-world challenges. Equally important is the concurrent integration of Indigenous Knowledge Systems into contemporary learning. India's rich knowledge traditions offer valuable insights into sustainability, resourcefulness, materials and community practices, helping students develop *Desi* solutions that are both technologically informed and grounded in regional contexts.

Such an approach is particularly relevant for India. As our country addresses rapid urbanisation, climate resilience, infrastructure, sustainable production, and digital ecosystems, it requires well-trained professionals capable of working across sectors. The future workforce will increasingly be shaped by our ability to connect knowledge and apply it thoughtfully to complex situations. Interdisciplinary education can nurture precisely this capability.

As India advances towards the vision of Viksit Bharat, preparing well-trained, appropriately skilled professionals is not merely an educational priority. It is an important part of building the intellectual and human capacity required to address the country's complex developmental challenges and shape a more inclusive, sustainable and future-ready society.



The end of academic islands: Why the future belongs to interdisciplinary thinkers

SRABANI BASU

The writer is an Associate Professor in the Department of Literature and Languages, SRM University, Andhra Pradesh

There was a time when disciplines behaved like neighbours who politely acknowledged one another from across the fence but never accepted invitations for tea. Physicists stayed with physicists, psychologists with psychologists, and literature professors discussed metaphors while engineers built bridges. Everyone secretly believed the other group lived on a different planet. Today, however, those fences are beginning to look rather unnecessary. The world has developed a stubborn habit of refusing to fit into departmental folders.

Climate change does not know where Environmental Science ends and Economics begins. Artificial Intelligence is blissfully unaware that universities have separate buildings for Computer Science and Philosophy. Mental health quietly borrows from neuroscience, psychology, sociology, medicine, education and even literature without asking anyone's permission. Reality, unlike universities, has never

believed in departments. Perhaps that is why interdisciplinary research has shifted from being an attractive option to an unavoidable necessity.

Ironically, academia has always admired polymaths while simultaneously creating systems that discourage becoming one. Leonardo da Vinci never seemed particularly concerned about whether anatomy belonged to medicine or art. Shakespeare explored the depths of human psychology centuries before psychology became a recognised discipline. Darwin borrowed ideas from economics. Einstein immersed himself in philosophy. Carl Jung wandered through mythology, anthropology, religion and alchemy with remarkable ease. None of them appeared anxious about crossing disciplinary boundaries. It seems curiosity has always ignored institutional borders.

Somewhere along the journey, however, we became remarkably efficient at dividing knowledge into beautifully labelled drawers. The only problem was that reality refused to cooperate. Knowledge became organised. Problems did not.

Consider something as ordinary as a cup of

coffee. A chemist studies its molecular composition. A neuroscientist investigates how caffeine influences cognition. A psychologist explores why it comforts us. An economist analyses global coffee markets. A historian traces its journey across civilisations. A literary scholar notices how cafés became breeding grounds for revolutions, poetry and philosophy. Each discipline opens a different window. Interdisciplinary thinking allows us to walk through the entire house. This is not an argument against specialisation. Specialists remain indispensable. Expertise matters. Depth matters. But depth without connection can slowly become isolation. The future does not require us to abandon expertise. It asks us to build bridges between expertise.

Perhaps the most significant shift taking place today is not in knowledge itself but in the kinds of questions we are asking. Increasingly, the world rewards those who ask better questions. How should Artificial Intelligence make ethical decisions? Can storytelling improve healthcare outcomes? How does architecture influence emotional well-being? How do algorithms reshape democracy? Each of these questions immediately recruits multiple disciplines into the conversation. Artificial Intelligence has accelerated this transformation dramatically. The competitive advantage is no longer access to knowledge. It is the ability to connect knowledge. Such connections emerge not from databases but from imagination. Today, knowledge resembles a living ecosystem. Psychology speaks to

neuroscience. Neuroscience speaks to education. Education speaks to technology. Technology speaks to ethics. Every conversation enriches another. Maybe knowledge was never fragmented. Only our filing system was.

William Blake once wrote, "Without contraries is no progression." Few statements capture the spirit of interdisciplinary research more beautifully. It invites dialogue rather than domination, collaboration rather than competition, and integration rather than isolation. It reminds us that different ways of knowing need not compete for supremacy. They can illuminate one another.

The future, therefore, may not belong to those who know the most within a single discipline. It may belong to those who can recognise meaningful patterns across disciplines, connect ideas that others consider unrelated and remain intellectually humble enough to keep learning from unfamiliar territories. The age of academic islands is gradually drawing to a close. The bridges are already being built. The only question that remains is whether we are willing to walk across them.



Iran will return to ceasefire if US does, says President

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Dubai

Iran’s president said on Tuesday that his country is ready to return to the ceasefire deal reached with the United States in June if Washington does the same, in conciliatory remarks following the first exchange of fire between the two countries in a month.

Iran’s president says his country would return to ceasefire agreement if US does as well

Speaking on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation summit in Kyrgyzstan, Iran’s President Masoud Pezeshkian said that “if the US returns to its commitments in the memorandum of understanding, the Islamic Republic of Iran will immediately reciprocate,” Iranian state media reported.

The June memorandum of understanding provided for an immediate ceasefire and started a 60-day period for negotiations aimed at



reaching a wider peace deal. Iran agreed to clear the Strait of Hormuz of mines and allow ships to pass during the period, and the US agreed to end its naval blockade, lift sanctions, issue waivers for Iranian oil exports and begin work on a reconstruction package for Iran, among other things.

The agreement broke down quickly, and while there has been a lull in fighting, the two sides exchanged fire on the weekend with the US targeting Iranian missile launchers on Larak Island, in

the Strait of Hormuz, and Iran responding by firing missiles at American military facilities in Jordan, which were intercepted.

While Pezeshkian has long favoured a negotiated end to the war, the most powerful force in Iran remains the paramilitary Revolutionary Guard, which is pressing for greater concessions from the US, including Iranian control over the Strait of Hormuz and financial compensation for the war. Those conditions would likely be unacceptable to

Washington. The leaders of China, Russia and India are all attending the summit in Kyrgyzstan, which has been billed as a counterweight to US global influence.

Iran’s foreign minister has already held meetings with his Chinese counterpart and Pezeshkian was due to have talks with Russian President Vladimir Putin later Tuesday.

The British military’s United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre said it received reports of an attack on a ship in the Strait of Hormuz, and a second report of an incident involving a tanker in waters nearby. In the first incident, the UKMTO said a tanker was hit by three projectiles on Monday on its way out of the Persian Gulf through the strait east of Oman.

The monitoring agency said there were no reports of casualties on the boat or of any environmental impact caused by the attack.

In the second incident,

DAR CALLS FOR IMPLEMENTING ISLAMABAD MOU TO ENSURE WEST ASIA PEACE

Islamabad: Pakistan Foreign Minister Ishaq Dar on Tuesday met Iranian counterpart Abbas Araghchi and said that the “sincere implementation” of the Islamabad MoU was the only way forward to resolve the ongoing conflict in West Asia. The two leaders met on the sidelines of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) summit in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, according to Pakistan’s Foreign Office (FO).“The DPM underscored that dialogue and diplomacy remain essential to promoting peace and stability in the region, and that sincere implementation by both parties to the

conflict of the Islamabad Memorandum of Understanding (MoU)of June 2026 remains the only way forward,” the FO said in a statement on X.

In June, the US and Iran signed a MoU, aimed at bringing peace in West Asia. Pakistan also signed the document as a “guarantor”.

The negotiations collapsed in early July with renewed military strikes amid mutual accusations of agreement violations and deadlocked demands over the Strait of Hormuz - the Gulf chokepoint through which about a fifth of the world’s energy supplies passed in peacetime. (PTI)



People wait for assistance and updates as a rescue operation continues after the devastating flash floods in Rasuwa, Nepal

Nepal floods: Death toll crosses 1,000 as rescuers recover more bodies

SHIRISH B PRADHAN
■ Kathmandu

The death toll from the devastating flash floods in Nepal surged to 1,050 on Tuesday, with security forces recovering more bodies from eight districts of the country, officials said.

Rescuers struggled to trace those stranded amid intermittent rainfall and a fresh flood alert as water levels rose in rivers across eastern, central and western parts of Nepal.

Nearly 4,000 people, including 583 foreigners and 83 security personnel, still remain missing the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) said.

Around 12,000 people have been rescued, it said. Flash floods, triggered by a collapse or avalanche of ice and rock near the Nepal-Tibet border, devastated towns and villages in northern and central Nepal on August 26.

The Bhotekoshi River, which flows south from the Himalayan border region, carried the floodwaters downstream, sweeping away homes, vehicles, roads and bridges and damaging hydropower projects.

The disaster also killed 16 people on the Chinese side, while nearly 550 people

remain missing in Tibet, according to Chinese media reports. In Nepal, 321 bodies were recovered in Chitwan district, followed by 216 in Nawalparasi East, 170 in Nawalparasi West, 142 in Nuwakot, 65 in Gorkha, 57 in Dhading, 41 in Rasuwa and 38 in Tanahun, according to NDRRMA. Nepal’s hospitals are struggling to cope with the growing number of unidentified bodies. Large gatherings were witnessed at medical facilities, with people carrying photographs of missing relatives and scrutinising images of the dead posted on the walls.

Unidentified bodies have been kept at 21 hospitals across the country, officials said.

Of the total bodies recovered so far, only around 60 were handed over to relatives after identification, while nearly 700 were buried after documentation and preservation of identification records, officials said. Rescue teams are still trying to trace 683 workers and employees in various hydropower project sites in flood-hit areas, of which many are believed to be trapped in tunnels.

Expert teams from India and China are assisting the Nepalese rescuers in these operations. (PTI)

SOUTH COAST RAILWAY VISAKHAPATNAM

Follow us on @SCoRailway
Website: www.scor.indianrailways.gov.in

e-Tender Notice No STCVSKP-Utilitshift-OT001, Date: 29.08.2026

For and on behalf of the President of India, Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer, Construction, Visakhapatnam, South Coast Railway invites e-bids at website <http://www.ireps.gov.in> for the under mentioned works form the tenderers fulfilling the requisite eligibility criteria.

Name of work: Shifting of infringing Signalling and Telecommunication cables and gears for facilitating Construction/Civil Engineering work in connection with Multitracking works in Visakhapatnam Division of South Coast Railway, **Approx Cost of the work:** Rs.26.62,03,985.87, **Cost of tender document:** Nil, **Earnest Money/Bid Security to be deposited:** Rs.53,24,100.00, **Completion period of the work:** 24 (Twenty Four) Months, **Tender Closing Date, Time:** 29-09-2026 at 16:00 Hrs.

No manual offers sent by Post/Courier/Fax or in person shall be accepted against such e-tenders even if these are submitted on firm’s letter head and received in time. All such manual offers shall be considered invalid and shall be rejected summarily without any consideration.

Complete information including e-tender documents of the above e-tender is available in website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. The prospective tenderers are advised to revisit the website fifteen days before the date of closing of tender to note any changes/corrigenda issued for this tender. The tenders/bidders must have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate and must be registered on IREPS portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering.

The tenderers should read all instructions to the tenderers carefully and ensure compliance of all instructions including check lists, Para 3.1 (additional check-list) of Tender form (Second sheet) Annexure-I of Chapter 2 of Tender documents.

Dy. Chief Signal & Telecom Engineer/ Construction/Visakhapatnam

No. B/E. CN(GS)/61// RENGUNTA N, Date: 31.08.2026

Chief Electrical Engineer (Construction), South Coast Railway, Visakhapatnam, invites e-tender on behalf of the President of India for the following works in a single packet system of tendering:

Sl. No. 1, NIT No.: Tender No. 04-2026-2027-E-GS-CN-GTL: **Name of the work:** Electrical Construction/ GTL - Electrical arrangements for Pre-NI and NI for RENGUNTA yard Modification works: Provision of Temporary un-interrupted power supply & Lighting arrangements for a period of approximately 47 days in connection with Pre-NI/NI working including Provision of Electrical arrangements for RRI Cabin in connection with RY Yard modification works at RENGUNTA Station., **Details: Estimate Cost:** Rs. 2,35,58,857.51, **EMD:** Rs.4,71,200.00, **Tender Document Cost:** Nil, **Completion period:** 06 (Six) months, **Date of closing:** 21/09/2026 at 15:00 hrs.

1. For bid document and other details, please login to website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>

2. The Bid Security/EMD shall be deposited either in cash through e-payment gateway in IREPS or submitted as Bank Guarantee bond in favour of FA&CAO/C/VSKP from a scheduled commercial bank of India or as mentioned in tender documents. The Bank Guarantee bond shall be as per Annexure-VIA and shall be valid for a period of 120 days beyond the bid validity period.

3. Tenderer can submit their offers online during tender submission period which is fifteen days period to closing of tender.

4. Tenderer should watch for any Corrigenda (issued online only) upto the date of commencement of the Tender submission period.

Chief Electrical Engineer/Construction/SCoR-A277 Visakhapatnam

For further tender conditions/ details and for downloading the tender documents, please visit the website at <https://www.ireps.gov.in>.

Indian among 12 killed in attacks on Ukraine: Zelenskyy

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
■ London

An Indian citizen was among 12 people killed in the latest Russian attacks on Ukraine, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said on Tuesday, as drones and ballistic missiles struck several cities in the eastern European nation, damaging residential buildings and civilian infrastructure.

Since Monday evening, guided aerial bomb and drone strikes have continued against Odesa city and the surrounding region, leaving thousands of families without electricity, Zelenskyy said in a social media post. “Overall, 12 people were killed, among them an Indian citizen,” he said. “My condolences to everyone who has lost family



and loved ones,” the Ukrainian president added.

Zelenskyy said dozens of people were injured in the attacks, which also hit Kyiv, Odesa, Kherson, Donetsk, Zaporizhzhia, Kharkiv, Chernihiv, Zhytomyr, Sumy and Dnipro regions.

In Kyiv, seven people were killed in a strike on a railway depot. In Boryspil, a five-storey residential building was damaged, and 50 people were evacuated, while four people were killed and 13 injured in the city, Zelenskyy said. He said nearly 350 first responders were involved in rescue and recovery

operations in Kyiv and the surrounding region alone.

“A significant number of jet-powered drones and ballistic missiles were used in the attack,” Zelenskyy said, adding that residential buildings and civilian infrastructure were damaged.

Russian guided aerial bomb and drone strikes

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM’s Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

Name of work with its location (Phase)	Augmentation/Replacement of Contact wire over Delhi Division (8th Phase)
Approx. Cost of work	Rs.1,53,06,448.56/-
Earnest Money Deposit	Rs.3,06,100/-
E-Tender Bid Online Submission period	16.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 30.09.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)
E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time	30.09.2026 (15.00 hrs)
Fund Allocation	Capital (PH-36)
Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.ireps.gov.in
E-Tender No.: 08D-TRD-NILS-2026-27	Dated : 01.09.2026
3010/2026	

Serving Customers With A Smile

ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण
प्लॉट संख्या-01, सैक्टर-१ नॉलेज पार्क-4 ग्रेटर नोएडा सिटी,
जिला-गौतमबुद्ध नगर (उप्र ०)

सार्वजनिक सूचना

ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अन्तर्गत M/s Rudra Buildwell Projects Pvt. Ltd. भूखण्ड संख्या- GH-02B, Sector-01, Greater Noida को दिनांक 21.05.2014 को मानचित्र स्वीकृति प्रदान की गयी थी। तदोपरान्त विकासकर्ता द्वारा (Group Housing Project) का पुरोहित मानचित्र स्वीकृति हेतु आवेदन संख्या-SCR-28313 दिनांक 17.06.2026 के माध्यम से आवेदन किया गया है। तदनुसार UP-Apartment Act&-2010, Amendment 2016 in Section-4 Sub Section-8 के अन्तर्गत परियोजना के आवेदितों से आपत्ति/सुझाव आमंत्रित किये जाने का प्रावधान है। इस सम्बन्ध में विकासकर्ता द्वारा प्रस्तुत स्वीकृति मानचित्र एवं Declarations as per UP Apartment Act-2010 का परीक्षण किसी भी कार्यदिवस में सुबह 9.30 से सायं 6:00 बजे के मध्य नियोजन विभाग में तथा प्राधिकरण को वेबसाइट पर किया जा सकता है।
अतः उपरोक्त परियोजना के आवेदितों द्वारा Sanction Map एवं Declarations as per UP Apartment Act-2010 के सम्बन्ध में सूचना प्रकाशित करने के 30 दिनों के अन्दर आपत्ति/सुझाव आमंत्रित की जाती है। उपरोक्त के निहितार्थ अपनी आपत्ति/सुझाव Email Id-gmplanung@gnida.in पर अथवा लिखित रूप में अपने आवेदन पत्र, नाम, पता एवं दूरभाष नम्बर के साथ कार्यालय समय व कार्यदिवस में ग्रेटर नोएडा प्राधिकरण के मुख्य प्रशासनिक कार्यालय, भूखण्ड संख्या-1, नॉलेज पार्क-4, ग्रेटर नोएडा में स्थित महाप्रबन्धक (नियोजन/वास्तु) को सम्बोधित करते हुए सूचना प्रकाशित होने के 30 दिनों के अन्दर जमा करायी जा सकती है।
प्रभारी महाप्रबन्धक (नियोजन/वास्तु)
ग्रेटर नोएडा औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida-201301 (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPCL Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority’s official website: www.noidaauthorityonline.in & <https://etender.up.nic.in>. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1.	35/GM/AO/Sr. M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET, Annual Maintenance of Staff Quarter Type-I,II, III & IV in Sector-27, Noida. Cost Rs. 41.44 Lacs.
2.	39/GM/AO/Sr. M.(E&M)-II/2026-27/ET, Providing of lighting work in Sector-20, NOIDA. Cost Rs. 38.83 Lacs.

Which can be uploaded by date: 15.09.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date:- 16.09.2026 at 11.00 AM

(B)

1.	04/GM/(E/M)Sr.M (E/M)-IV/2026-27, S/II/T/C of 02 Nos CNG Furnace in CNG Crimination at Antim Niwas Sector-94, Noida. Cost Rs. 99.84 Lacs.
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Which can be uploaded by date: 08.09.2026 Upto 5.00 PM. pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date: - 09.09.2026 at 11.00 AM

General Manager (E&M) NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

UNITY
Small Finance Bank

UNITY SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED
5th Floor, Tower 1, Seawoods Grand Central, Sec-40, Seawoods, above Seawoods Darave Railway Station, Navi Mumbai – 400 706

POSSESSION NOTICE

Whereas the undersigned being the authorized officer of **Unity Small Finance Bank Limited** (hereinafter referred to as “USFBL”), Having its registered office at 5th Floor, Tower 1, Seawoods Grand Central, Sec-40, Seawoods, above Seawoods Darave Railway Station, Navi Mumbai – 400 706 under Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002), and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued Demand Notice dated mentioned below under Section 13(2) of the said Act calling upon you being the borrowers (names and addresses mentioned below) to repay the amount mentioned in the said notice and interest thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice. The borrower mentioned herein below having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrowers mentioned herein below and to the public in general that undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on me under sub section (4) of section 13 of the Act read with the Rule 8 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002. The borrowers mentioned herein in above in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the said property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the Charge of **Unity Small Finance Bank Limited** for an amount as mentioned herein under and interest thereon. The Borrower’s attention is invited to provisions of sub section (8) of Section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Co-Borrower (s)	Description of Immovable Properties is as Under	Demand Notice Date & Amount	Date of Possession
1	Loan A/C. No(S): CSDDELLOAN0005000943 & USFBDDELLOAN0005011148 1. Prem Rawat Ready Made Garments (Borrower) Represented Through By Jyoti 2. Jyoti (Co-Borrower & Mortgage) 3. Prem Singh (Co-Borrower) Add For Sr. No. 1, 2 & 3 : Asaoti Near Railway Stations Road Faridabad Haryana 121102. Add For Sr. No. 1 : Thewt Khatano- 24/36, 363/474, 367/478 Kilaano- 19/1 (1-8), 18 (8-0), 19/2 (4-0), 23/1 (1-15) 23/2 (6-5), 22 (8-0) Mustakil No. 30 Waka Mauja Asauti Tehsil District Palwal Haryana 201102.	All That Piece And Parcel Of The Immovable Property Related To Residential Property Area Measuring 2 Marla 1 c. 60 Sq Yds. Comprised in Kheawat/Khata No.24/36, Mustakil No.30, Killa No.19/1(1-8), And Kheawat/Khata No.363/474, Mustakil No.30, Killa No.18(8-0), 19/2(4-0), Kheawat/Khata No. 366/476, Mustakil No.30, Killa No.23/1(1-15), 23/2(6-5), And Kheawat/Khata No 367/478, Mustakil No.30, Killa No.22(8-0), Situated At Waka Mauja Asawati, Tehsil And District Palwal, Faridabad, Haryana 121102, India Being Bounded As: Boundaries (As Per Mortgage/Sale Document); East : Other Property, West : Road, North : Shop Of Mr. Lekhraj, South : House Of Ramchand Measurments: Area Measuring 60 Sq. Yards. (2marla) (20X27)	08.04.2026 Rs. 13,19,251.46/- (Rupees Thirteen Lakh Nineteen Thousand Two Hundred Fifty One And Forty Six Paise Only) As On 07.04.2026	28.08.2026

Place : Delhi
Date : 02.09.2026

Sd/-
Authorized Officer
Unity Small Finance Bank Limited

SBI

STATE BANK OF INDIA
HOME LOAN CENTRE-CUM-SARC-II, COREENTHUM BUILDING, GROUND FLOOR, SECTOR-62, NOIDA, DISTT.-GAUTAM BUDDH NAGAR, U.P.-201301

DEMAND NOTICE

NOTICE U/S 13(2) OF THE SECURITIZATION & RECONSTRUCTION OF FINANCIAL ASSETS & ENFORCEMENT OF SECURITY INTEREST ACT, 2002 (NO. 54 OF 2002) (HEREINAFTER CALLED "ACT").

Whereas the undersigned being the Authorised Officer of State Bank of India under SARFAESI Act and in exercise of powers conferred under Section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of Rules, issued Demand Notice under Section 13(2) of the said Act, calling upon the Borrowers / Mortgageors / Guarantors listed here under (hereinafter referred to as the "said Borrowers"), to repay the amounts mentioned in the Notice, within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice, as per detail given below. The said Notice has either been returned undelivered by the postal authorities or have not been acknowledged by the borrowers / mortgageors / guarantors. Hence the Bank by way of abundant caution is effecting this publication of the demand notice. The undersigned has therefore, caused these Notice to be pasted on the premises of the last known addresses of the said Borrowers / Mortgageors / Guarantors as per the said Act. Copies of the said Notices are available with the undersigned; and the said Borrowers/ Mortgageors/ Guarantors, may, if they so desire, collect the said copies from the undersigned on any working day during normal office hours. Against the above background, Notice is hereby given, once again, to said Borrowers / Mortgageors / Guarantors to pay to State Bank of India, within 60 days from the date of publication of this Notice, the amounts indicated here in below together with future interest at contractual rates and rests from the dates mentioned below till the date of payment under the Loan & other documents. As security for due repayment of the loan, the following assets have been mortgaged / hypothecated to State Bank of India by the respective borrowers. If the said borrowers / mortgageors / guarantors fail to make payment to State Bank of India as aforesaid. Then State Bank of India shall proceed against the above secured assets under Section 13(4) of the SARFAESI Act and Rules entirely at the risk of the said borrowers / mortgageors / guarantors as to the costs and consequences. Further, attention is invited to provisions of Sub-section (B) of the Section 13 of the SARFAESI Act. In respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets. You are prohibited under the SARFAESI Act from transferring the secured assets, whether by way of sale, Lease or other wise without the prior written consent of State Bank of India. Any person who contravenes or abets contravention of the provisions of the Act or Rules shall be liable for imprisonment and/or fine as given under Section 29 of the Act.

DESCRIPTION OF THE IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

Name and Address of Borrower / Mortgageor / Guarantor	Details of the Security to be enforced	Amount O/s as per 13(2) Notice	Demand Notice Date
MR. HIMANSHU S/O MR. JAIPAL SINGH Plot No.21, Block D, Sector 61, Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301. Home Loan A/c. No.: 32589938471 Home Loan Suraksha A/c. No.: 32589950158	Immovable Property: All that part and parcel of the Property - Plot No. 21, Block D, Sector 61, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh-201301.	Rs.14,00,313/- (Rupees Fourteen Lakh Three Hundred Thirteen Only) sum total of all two accounts as on 06.06.2026 with further interest and incidental expenses at the contractual rate on the aforesaid amount together cost, charges etc. thereon	06.06.2026 NPA Date 05.06.2026

Place : NOIDA Date: 01.09.2026

Authorized Officer, State Bank of India, Home Loan Centre-2, Sector-62, Noida

Pradipkumar Babunah, R/O-
Vill- Pipaliya, PO- Chhavad,
T.S- Godhra, Dist-
Anandmahal, Gujarat- 389120,
I have changed my name from
Pradipmahabhen to Baria
Pradipmahabhen Pradipkumar, vide
affidavit dated 01/09/2026
before Notary Public Delhi.

Sd/-, Suhali Jain, R/o E-532,
1st Floor, Greater Kailash
Part-2, New Delhi-110048, am
requesting correction of
spelling of my name from
Pradipmahabhen to Suhali Jain on
my passport.

IRDAI proposes public insurance registry for promoting affordability

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Regulator IRDAI on Tuesday proposed a public insurance registry (PIR), envisaged as a digital public infrastructure, for promoting affordability and financial sustainability.

The proposed infrastructure is intended to enable technology, governance and market participation to work together towards wider and deeper financial resilience. The Insurance Regulatory and Development Authority of India (IRDAI) has released a consultation paper in this regard.

The proposed PIR represents a significant step towards building a more connected, transparent, efficient and resilient insurance ecosystem, with trusted information serving as a foundation for better protection, innovation and public value,



and a strategic investment in national economic infrastructure, the PIR will strengthen consumer protection, market efficiency, insurance coverage and supporting the next generation of insurance reforms," IRDAI said.

Further, it has the potential to lower information barriers, promote competition and enable market participants to differentiate through product innovation, pricing, service quality and customer experience, the regulator added.

The consultation paper has been conceived through a user-centric approach, anchored in the needs and challenges of diverse stakeholders across the insurance ecosystem."It seeks to translate these needs into tangible outcomes by enabling more seamless, transparent and data-driven insurance journeys and decision-making,"

and a strategic investment in national economic infrastructure, the PIR will strengthen consumer protection, market efficiency, insurance coverage and supporting the next generation of insurance reforms," IRDAI said.

Further, it has the potential to lower information barriers, promote competition and enable market participants to differentiate through product innovation, pricing, service quality and customer experience, the regulator added.

The consultation paper has been conceived through a user-centric approach, anchored in the needs and challenges of diverse stakeholders across the insurance ecosystem."It seeks to translate these needs into tangible outcomes by enabling more seamless, transparent and data-driven insurance journeys and decision-making,"

IrdaI said. The envisioned use cases span across eight stakeholders, including insurers, reinsurers, intermediaries, and financial institutions.

PIR will adopt a DPI-based approach using technology, governance and market to support the societal goal of wider and deeper financial resilience, the paper said, and added regulatory guardrails will guide market-based risk pooling and leveraging competitive private innovation in the public interest. IRDAI has invited comments and feedback from stakeholders by September 30.

PIR draws encouragement from the success of and lessons from DPIs in other sectors of the economy such as JAM trinity, credit information bureaus, Unified Payments Interface, DigiYatra, PM GatiShakti, Government e-Marketplace (GeM), among others.

IIS officers vital link between Govt, citizens: I&B Secretary

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Indian Institute of Mass Communication (IIMC) on Tuesday hosted the Valedictory Function and Graduation Ceremony for Group A Officer Trainees of the Indian Information Service (IIS), representing the 2009, 2023 and 2024 batches.

The ceremony marked a historic milestone for IIMC and the Indian Information Service, with IIMC conferring postgraduate degrees on IIS Officer Trainees for the first time after becoming a Deemed to be University.

The officer trainees were awarded the MA in Public Communication & Governance on successful completion of the prescribed academic and professional requirements. The introduction of the MA programme represents an important step towards further strengthening the academic component of IIS professional training and integrating the study of public communication, media and governance.



At the valedictory function, Chanchal Kumar, Secretary, Ministry of Information and Broadcasting, said that public communication is an integral part of governance and must evolve with changing technologies and platforms. He noted that officers must remain aware of emerging technologies, with AI becoming a game-changer, even as misinformation, deepfakes, and synthetically generated content pose new challenges.

He emphasised that communication must be a two-way process, with citizen feedback helping improve policies and their implementation.

While speed is important, he said, accuracy and credibility remain non-negotiable, as every communication carries the authority of the institution.

He further stated that officers must continuously upgrade their skills, stay connected with the field, and be prepared to take up and understand other aspects of governance when entrusted with responsibilities beyond communication. Above all, he said, citizens must remain at the centre, with officers always asking whether their work is helping people, particularly the poorest of the poor. If not,

they must rethink and replan, and always look at people's concerns compassionately and work towards helping them.

At the ceremony, Dr Pragya Paliwal Gaur, VC, IIMC, said the officer trainees are the first recipients of this PG degree, reflecting the strengthening of IIMC's academic role and its close relationship with professional communication training. She said communication is about creating understanding, not just transmitting information, and that officer trainees must approach their responsibilities with clarity, objectivity, and sensitivity. She added that the MA degree is a reminder of the importance of continued learning in a constantly evolving field.

The ceremony was graced by the presence of Prabhat, Additional Secretary, Ministry of Information and Broadcasting; KK Nirala, Joint Secretary, Ministry of Information and Broadcasting; L Madhu Nag, Director General, Training; senior officers, faculty members and officer trainees.

Karnataka to be global wellbeing model: Health minister Khader

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bengaluru

Karnataka Health Minister UT Khader has unveiled an ambitious vision to position Karnataka as a global destination for health, immunity and holistic wellbeing, at the Global Wellbeing Confluence (GWC) — 2026 Leaders Talk, conducted in association with AYUSH TV, India's dedicated health channel.

In a powerful interaction with Harish R, Chairman, GWC — 2026, the Minister highlighted the importance of creating greater public awareness about what people eat, where they eat and how food and lifestyle influence long-term health. His recent enforcement initiatives covering five-star hotels, leading clubs, hospitals, bakeries, sweet outlets and pharmaceutical establishments have reinforced the need for stronger public vigilance and responsible health practices.

The Minister also inaugurated "AYUSH Life Immunity Prasadam - One Meal a Day," promoting the use of sea-



sonal vegetables, fruits and natural foods as part of an immunity-focused lifestyle. He further released 10 powerful principles for an immunity-enriched lifestyle, providing a simple roadmap for healthier living.

The 2026 edition is scheduled for October 23-26, 2026, at Palace Grounds, Bengaluru, with expectations of participation from more than 15,000 AYUSH and modern medicine doctors, along with healthcare professionals, wellness experts, institutions and the public.

The AYUSH Federation of India is the official partner, with associate partnerships from organisations including the Akhila Karnataka Rajya Sarkari Mahila Noukarara Sangha, Karnataka Drugs and Pharmaceuticals

Manufacturers Association, and Indian Naturopathy & Yoga Graduates Medical Association, among others.

The GWC — 2026 launch event was attended by Hari Krishna M, Managing Director, AYUSH TV; A Jayasimha, Chairman, Karnataka State Brahmin Development Board; and Pavan S Ramesh of AYUSH TV, along with distinguished representatives from the healthcare and wellbeing sectors.

Global Wellbeing Confluence — 2026 aims to bring AYUSH, modern medicine, nutrition, naturopathy, yoga and preventive healthcare onto one powerful platform creating a movement that can make Karnataka a model for healthy and sustainable living for India and the world.

Fisheries secretary launches national plan for small-scale fishers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Puducherry

India has moved into the next crucial phase in the development of the National Plan of Action for small-scale fisheries, taking the country a step closer towards the robust framework aimed at protecting livelihood of millions of small-scale fishers in the country.

Union Fisheries Secretary Dr Abhilash Likhie on Tuesday formally launched India's development phase of the National Plan of Action for Small-Scale Fisheries (NPOA-SSF) suggested by the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) of the United Nations. The country completed the initiation phase, involving assessment of the sector, stakeholder mapping and legal and governance gap analysis, following a stipulated framework by the FAO.

The final stage will be implementation, monitoring and evaluation of the NPOA to be developed at the present phase. The draft of the NPOA will be published on the occasion



of the World Fisheries Day on November 21. This was announced at the valedictory session of a two-day national workshop held in Puducherry to evaluate the first phase of the FAO-guided NPOA-SSF process.

Describing the exercise a crucial step in the development of small-scale fishers of the country, the Fisheries Secretary said that India's marine fisheries are small-scale, but they are also highly diverse. "The NPOA-SSF must move beyond being a policy document and become a practical framework that delivers meaningful support to the sector—strengthening livelihoods, improving safety, securing access to resources and building resilience among fishing communities", Dr Abhilash Likhie said.

AIIA launches special digital initiative AyurVarta

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

As a significant initiative to take the rich knowledge tradition, scientific perspective and global potential of Ayurveda to the masses, the All India Institute of Ayurveda (AIIA), New Delhi has launched a special digital dialogue series, 'AyurVarta', on the occasion of the upcoming Ayurveda Day.

Through 'AyurVarta', meaningful conversations with leading experts will be presented on important aspects of Ayurveda, contemporary healthcare challenges, scientific research, education, clinical practice, and the expanding global outreach of Ayurveda.

The inaugural episode of 'AyurVarta' featured a special dialogue between Professor (Vaidya) PK Prajapati, Director, AIIA, and Professor Dr Mahesh Vyas, Dean, Ph.D., AIIA. The central theme of the episode was: "Why is Ayurveda Day celebrated on 23 September?"

The discussion explored the history of Ayurveda Day,



its earlier observance on Dhanvantari Jayanti (Dhanteras), and the decision of the Government of India to designate a fixed date for the annual observance of Ayurveda Day.

On the occasion, Professor (Vaidya) PK Prajapati, Director, AIIA, said, "Under the visionary leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi ji, continuous efforts are being made to establish Ayurveda not only as India's ancient system of healthcare, but also as a significant knowledge and healthcare system with growing relevance in the global health landscape. This year, Ayurveda Day will be observed with great enthusiasm and on a wider scale not only across the country

but also in several countries around the world. This growing global participation reflects the increasing recognition and acceptance of Ayurveda internationally."

During the 'AyurVarta' discussion, Professor Dr Mahesh Vyas, Dean, Ph.D., AIIA, explained that 23 September falls around the Autumnal Equinox, a period when the duration of day and night is approximately equal. The concept of balance and equilibrium is central to the Ayurvedic understanding of health and well-being. In this context, the significance of 23 September also provides an important conceptual association with Ayurveda's emphasis on balance, harmony and equilibrium.

Daiv Vani

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The Weight We Choose to Carry

Purandara Dasa was once a wealthy merchant named Srinivasa Nayaka, until a moment of awakening led him to renounce his riches and walk the path of devotion. His wife, Saraswati Bai, chose to walk beside him. She let go of her jewels, her silks, her comforts — all except one small silver vessel she carried to fetch water.

At every stream, every stop along the way, she grew anxious — was the vessel safe, had she left it behind, would someone take it from her? Her mind, meant to dwell on the divine, kept returning to that one object.

Purandara Dasa watched this for days. Finally, he said to her, "You have given up everything, yet you still carry a burden. Throw the vessel into the river. Once it is gone, nothing will weigh on your mind again." She hesitated, then let it go — and with it, her restlessness.

We rarely renounce palaces or riches. But we all carry our own silver vessels — a feeling, a grudge, a regret, a need to be right — small enough to seem harmless, yet heavy enough to occupy the mind meant for peace.

Today, ask yourself: what is the one vessel you are still holding onto? Let it go, and feel how light the mind becomes.

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India Book Market Report 2026–30 to launch on September 3

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The Federation of Indian Publishers (FIP), in collaboration with NielsenIQ BookData, will launch the India Book Market Report 2026–2030 in New Delhi on September 3. The report offers a comprehensive assessment of the scale, structure, transformation and future growth opportunities of India's publishing industry.

Building on the previous India Book Market Report released in 2022, the latest study examines key forces expected to shape publishing through 2030, including artificial intelligence, digitisation, emerging distribution models, the growth of Indian-language publishing and India's expanding role in the global publishing ecosystem.

The report analyses print and digital publishing trends, includ-



ing e-books and audiobooks, across school, higher education, trade and scholarly publishing. It also examines the industry's economic contribution, employment, technology adoption, copyright and licensing, and the changing policy environment.

Pranav Gupta, Vice President, FIP and Project Leader of the report, said reliable data was essential for an industry of publishing's scale and strategic importance. He described the report as an "industry infrastructure project" aimed at creating a common evidence base for discussions on investment, technology, education, copyright, Indian languages, exports and public policy.

Vikrant Mathur, Executive Director, NielsenIQ BookData, India & GCC, said India's demographic profile, education ecosystem, linguistic diversity and technology adoption made it one of the world's most exciting and complex publishing markets.

The report combines industry research, stakeholder consultations and market intelligence to support decision-making by publishers, policymakers,

investors, educational institutions, technology companies, authors, booksellers and libraries.

Following its national launch, the report's findings are expected to contribute to international discussions on Indian publishing, including at the Frankfurt Book Fair 2026.

Bimal Gopalachari takes over as MD CCIC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Bimal Gopalachari takes over as Managing Director of Central Cottage Industries Corporation of India Limited (CCIC), a CPSU under the Ministry of Textiles, on 11th August 26. The appointment has been cleared by the Government.

Gopalachari, who previously served as Additional General Manager at NTPC Limited, has been appointed for a five-year term after receiving approval from the Government based on the recommendation of the Public Enterprises Selection Board (PESB).



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Notice Inviting Tender

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Tenders are hereby invited for the purchase and supply of following items:-

Sr. No.	Name of Work/Item	Period/Tentative Qty
1.	For Verka Mohali Dairy Annual rate contract for the purchase of Whey Protein Concentrate 80% (food grade)	Annual
2.	For Verka Bathinda Dairy a) DSITC of ETP equipments for upgradation of ETP unit. b) Hiring of insulated road milk tankers (cap.20 Ton & above) for transportation of milk within/ outside Punjab.	One complete job 05 No's
3.	For Verka Jalandhar Dairy Modification of existing Butter chum (cap.5 kl) Gear box system.	One job
4.	For Verka Gurdaspur Dairy a) Hiring of insulated road milk tankers for transportation of milk from Verka Gurdaspur Dairy to other milk unions (vice-versa) within and outside state. cap.10 & 15 MT-01, 20MT-02. b) Insulated vehicle for supply of milk & milk products. c) Udhampur to Srinagar route refrigerated vehicle for supply of fresh milk and milk products.	04 No's 02 years extendable for another one year/10 No's 02 years extendable for another one year
5.	For Verka Amritsar Dairy a) Branding & Advertising Material. b) Supply of Indonesian steam coal.	One Year 1000 MT
6.	For Verka Ludhiana Dairy Labour contract for loading/unloading of SMP/WMP bags, WMP tins, Ghee and butter cartons etc.	One year with extension up to one year
7.	For Verka Cattle Feed Plant, Bhatiana (Khanna) Labour job contract for different activities for production section, store section and marketing section.	Annual

NOTE:

1. For complete details regarding above tender (NIT), please visit our website i.e. www.verka.coop & e Tendering portal i.e. eproc.punjab.gov.in.

2. Corrigendum, if any, will be uploaded on website only.

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General Manager (Purchase)

BRIEFLY

Hariharan-Arjun retire on day 1 of China Masters



Unnati Hooda fell at the first hurdle in women's singles, while men's doubles pair Hariharan Amsakarunan and M R Arjun retired at the first-game interval of their opening-round match at the China Masters Super 750 badminton tournament here on Tuesday. Hooda, ranked world No. 25, went down 10-21, 18-21 to South Korea's world No. 12 Kim Ga Eun in the opening round.

Earlier, Hariharan and Arjun were trailing 8-11 in the opening game against China's Chen Bo Yang and Liu Yi when they decided to concede the match. The reason for their retirement was not immediately clear, although it appeared to be related to fitness. Hooda looked out of sorts in the opening game as Kim raced to a 4-0 lead and quickly stretched it to 11-3 before closing out the game. (PTI)

Man City bolsters attacking options by signing winger Allan



Manchester City signed Brazilian winger Allan and reportedly reached an agreement to purchase Senegal forward Iliman Ndiaye on Monday in an effort to strengthen its attacking options late in the transfer window.

The 22-year-old Allan moved from Palmeiras for 34 million pounds (\$46 million) and takes the place in the City squad vacated by Savio, who joined Tottenham last week. He is likely to have the same role as his compatriot - as a backup winger. Allan has never played for Brazil or for any of his country's age-group teams, so he arrives as a somewhat low-profile signing.

"This is a surreal moment for me," Allan said in a City statement. "Manchester City, with everything they have won over the past 15 years, are one of the most attractive clubs in the world for players. To be able to sit here today and say I have joined them is the proudest moment of my life." (AP)

By numbers: A look at Messi's 21 years with Argentina

STEVE DOUGLAS
■ Buenos Aires (Argentina)

Lionel Messi has graced a soccer field with Argentina for the last time. Arguably the greatest player of all time, Messi announced his retirement from the international game on Monday to bring an end to 21 years of service for his country.

Here's a by-the-numbers look at his time at the Albiceleste:

1 Messi won the World Cup once, in Qatar in 2022. He also reached the final two other times - in 2014 and 2026 when losing to Germany and Spain, respectively.

6 The number of World Cups in which Messi played (2006, 2010, 2014, 2018, 2022 and 2026), which is tied for the most with long-time rival Cristiano Ronaldo.



21 Messi scored 21 goals across those six World Cups. That is second only to France's Kylian Mbappe, who has 22 and has played in just three tournaments.

39 Messi was aged 39 when he announced his international retirement - 21 years after

making his debut for Argentina in a friendly against Hungary in August 2005. He barely lasted a minute of that game before getting sent off for elbowing an opponent.

125 Messi scored 125 international goals and

that's more than double the amount netted by any other Argentina player. The previous record was held by Gabriel Batistuta, who scored 54 in 78 appearances from 1991-2002. It is, though, second to Cristiano Ronaldo (146 goals) in the all-time scoring list in men's international soccer.

207 The total number of international appearances by Lionel Messi, which also is a national record but not an all-time record in men's football. Once again, he is Number 2 in the list behind Cristiano Ronaldo, who has played 233 games for Portugal. (AP)



Balogun is headed on transfer to Premier League club Everton



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ London

United States striker Folarin Balogun is set to head to Premier League team Everton on a transfer from Monaco, British media reported on Monday.

The transfer fee offered by Everton is reported to be in the range of 40 million pounds on a four-year deal, the British Press Association said. It said personal terms had yet to be worked out before the deal could be completed prior to Tuesday's transfer deadline.

The 25-year-old Balogun, who had two years remaining on a contract at Monaco, gained attention this summer scoring three goals

for the United States as it reached the knockout stage of the World Cup. He was the top scorer for the US team. He also made headlines after drawing a red card and a one-game suspension in a 2-0 victory over Bosnia and Herzegovina in a round-of-32 match.

The one-game suspension was deferred by FIFA after US President Donald Trump intervened, allowing Balogun to play in the round of 16. Balogun eventually played in the 4-1 loss to Belgium that ended the US team's home World Cup run. The intervention prompted a formal complaint to FIFA ethics investigators.

Stan Wawrinka's Grand Slam career ends as the 2016 US Open champion falls to Matteo Berrettini



BRIAN MAHONEY ■ New York

Stan Wawrinka's Grand Slam career ended Monday when the 2016 US Open champion lost 7-6 (4), 7-6 (3), 6-0 to Matteo Berrettini.

Wawrinka won the last of his three major titles in Flushing Meadows when he beat Novak Djokovic in the final 10 years ago. At 41, he was given a wild

card into the event in what he has said will be his final season before retiring. "I'm going to miss it for sure. I'm going to miss it big time. I love the game," Wawrinka said before

he was honored on the court by US Tennis Association officials. The match appeared similar to meeting between the same players at Wimbledon, when Berrettini won a four-setter, with each going to a tiebreaker.

But after Wawrinka had his serve broken to start the third set — despite winning a key point when video review was used — Berrettini quickly pulled away. Wawrinka made his 18th US Open appearance. He initially thought he wouldn't get a goodbye to the tournament when the USTA gave its final men's singles wild card to American Patrick Kypson, who is ranked No. 115.

Wawrinka had already come to New York, so decided to return home last Monday to Switzerland. (AP)

Wimbledon champion Linda Noskova is back in Grand Slam mode at the US Open

STEPHEN WHYNO ■ New York

Linda Noskova's life changed earlier this summer in ways she could not possibly imagine. The 21-year-old from the Czech Republic won Wimbledon, the youngest champion there in a decade and a half, for her first Grand Slam title. She met Czech president Petr Pavel and was celebrated by thousands in her hometown of Vsetin.

"A lot of congratulations from people that weren't really expected," she said. Back at a major for first time at US Open, Noskova understands the gravity of what she has accomplished but insists it has not changed how she approaches tennis, with her eyes on more prizes ahead. "It has always been very important to focus on each match like nothing ever happened before: no success or no failure," Noskova said. "Whatever happened happened, and this is a brand-new tournament. I just have to start all over."



It's not totally starting over. She will always have that Wimbledon run on her resume, and she has improved from 12th to a career-best sixth in the WTA world rankings.

Still, Noskova called not getting ahead of herself the most important thing, which she believes is easy. After falling behind 5-2 in the first set of her opening match Monday against 78th-ranked American opponent Katie Volynets, Noskova rallied to win it 7-5, 6-1.

"I really want to stay the same - not really change many things around

me," Noskova said. "Whenever there is something new or something I'm not used to, I just kind of always want to stick with the things that I know how to do, and whatever is new, I just kind of get used to it."

Knowing it's about "What have you done for me lately?" Noskova acknowledges the media attention will not last forever. Going all the way at the All-England Club did give her confidence that she can hang with the best women's players on the planet, which helps at a US Open that looks wide open. (AP)

Carlos Alcaraz returns to US Open with a victory, Sabalenka also wins her first match

BRIAN MAHONEY ■ New York

Carlos Alcaraz returned to the U.S. Open and looked healthy enough for a run at a repeat.

Alcaraz beat Roman Safiullin 6-4, 6-4, 6-4 on Monday, showing no problems with the right wrist injury that had sidelined the 23-year-old Spaniard since April.

Following fellow two-time U.S. Open champion Aryna Sabalenka onto Arthur Ashe Stadium, the No. 2-seeded Alcaraz appeared more comfortable as the match went on and delivered the all-around game that has made him a fan favorite in New York. He held his hand to his ear to encourage louder cheers and pumped his fist after a pretty volley winner in the final game of the match. "I'm just really happy that I was able to compete again," Alcaraz said. "I think the level of tennis is going to be better for sure. I'm just really happy with the level that I played my first match."

If the seven-time Grand Slam champion stays healthy, he may quickly become a huge favorite with top-ranked Jannik Sinner sidelined by a knee injury and No. 4 Novak Djokovic losing in the U.S. Open's first



round for the first time on Sunday.

With the tournament thrown into shock by that result - Djokovic had been 19-0 in the first round at Flushing Meadows, where he won four of his men's-record 24 Grand Slam titles - Sabalenka brought back some normalcy.

Sabalenka beat Camila Osorio 6-4, 6-4 to begin her bid to be the first player to win three straight U.S. Open cham-

pionships since Serena Williams from 2012-14.

She has been to the last three U.S. Open finals, rebounding from a loss to Coco Gauff in 2023 by winning in 2024 and then topping Amanda Anisimova last year to repeat.

"I feel like this is one of my favorite stadiums," Sabalenka told the crowd afterward. "I really experienced best emotions here in this stadium." (AP)

DAILY SUDOKU

9				1			6
				3		2	
2	3	1	9		5		
3				8			4
		6	5		4	3	
	2			7			9
			2		9	4	1
		5		4			
4			8				3

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

HOW TO SOLVE IT

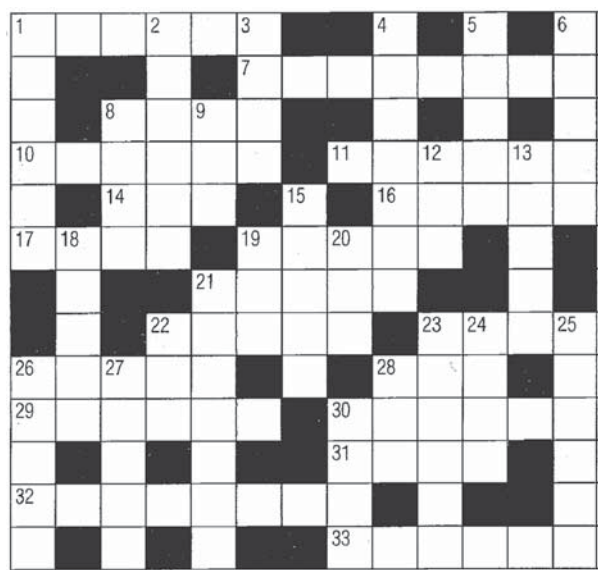
Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9x9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3x3 box, using elimination and logical deduction - no maths involved.



SOLUTION (1.9.26)

1	9	3	6	8	7	2	5	4
8	2	7	4	5	9	3	1	6
5	6	4	1	2	3	9	7	8
9	3	5	8	7	2	6	4	1
2	4	1	3	6	5	8	9	7
7	8	6	9	1	4	5	3	2
3	1	8	5	4	6	7	2	9
4	7	9	2	3	8	1	6	5
6	5	2	7	9	1	4	8	3

DOUBLE CROSSWORD WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 2, 2026



ACROSS

- Playing cards during a tennis match? (6)
- 7 A hero, but in this case a drawback (8)
- 8 So long, and thanks again (4)
- 10 Form of halo in the bathroom! (6)
- 11 Comfort for a little chap by an expert (6)
- 14 Tasty? No thanks! (3)
- 16 Free half of beer for a biker (5)
- 17 Pale due to having a fling? (4)
- 19 Poorer rhyme for a purse (5)
- 21 Stick a duck into a vessel! (5)
- 22 Appeal touchingly (5)
- 23 A smaller dog than Patch? (4)

DOWN

- Ali had to make a bloomer (6)
- Clever about boats? (6)
- 3 Even the top man can make a hash (4)
- 4 Again signals one's sorrow (7)
- 5 Like the days of Sarah, these modern times (5)
- 6 It slithers around (in summer?) (5)
- 8 Sort of nonsense to silence! (4)
- 9 Large stream of volunteers on the third of May (3)
- 12 The unbelievable part? (3)
- 13 A big fiddle leaving little room for love (4)
- 15 Entertainment no good during an emergency broadcast! (5)

- 26 Something afoot - e.g., wrecking boats (5)
- 28 Piece of pleasant land (3)
- 29 Merchant possibly tarred? (6)
- 30 A month with a broken leg could be hard on the nerves (6)
- 31 Leer at a playing error by the French (4)
- 32 Fish lake a female would presumably own (8)
- 33 Vessels coming to a tragic end in hasty manoeuvring? (6)

- 18 When refined, is it dearest? (5)
- 19 A little packing for the inner man? (3)
- 20 Animal in a meteoric rise (3)
- 21 One able to retrace his line of business? (5)
- 22 Immediate cash payment for fish (3)
- 23 Lances broken at the Battle of Hastings (4)
- 24 Attendant back to back with another? (4)
- 25 Puts one's foot down (6)
- 26 Turning bad, nevertheless (5)
- 27 Directions to a drinking place or rural shelters (5)
- 28 Wrap in cotton wool against the cold (3)
- 30 Australian youngster, a burden to his mum? (4)

SOLUTION (1.9.26)

ACROSS	19, B-esom	DOWN	15, Tunic
1, Lilac	20, Ideals	2, Imp-Ure	16, Den-se
6, B-ill-y	22, Ties	3, Amazon	18, Comic
9, Marbles	24, Nor	4, Cat(-walk)	19, Bloomer(-s)
10, Splat	25, Bicycle	5, Abbey	21, Dollar
11, C-rinch	26, Sonic	6, Be-ckha-M	22, Typist
12, Peris	27, CL-aim	7, Is-is	23, E-lated
13, Armoury	28, Ditto	8, Locket	25, Bible
15, Ted	29, Zeal-ous	12, Pries	26, Size 28, Due
17, Lean	30, Order	13, Ala-I-n	
18, Canute	31, E-tude	14, Mater	

Bumrah, Nitish included in squad for Afghanistan T20I series subject to fitness

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Pace spearhead Jasprit Bumrah, on Tuesday, was named in the Indian squad for the three-match T20I series against Afghanistan in the national Capital subject to fitness clearance as the selectors picked an identical team that will travel to Aichi-Nagoya for the Asian Games later this month. Afghanistan will be 'hosting' India for three T20Is to be played on September 13, 15 and 17 here at the Arun Jaitley Stadium. The squad also features all-rounders Nitish Kumar Reddy, Washington Sundar and fast bowler Harshit Rana, whose availability for the series to be hosted by the Afghanistan Cricket Board (ACB) is also subjected to fitness.

Bumrah returns to the squad after being sidelined due to an impact injury sustained on his knee during India's ODI series in England, and subsequently missed the team's two-Test series in Sri Lanka. Bumrah was advised rest by the BCCI medical team when it was time for selection of the Sri Lanka tour. Bumrah had suffered the impact injury to his knee and played through the IPL with it, largely looking off colour. With their workload management and future series in mind, Indian selectors had earmarked both Bumrah and Hardik Pandya for more



ODI cricket keeping the 2027 World Cup in mind, while also keeping the door open for recalling them any important assignments. Rana had suffered a right hamstring injury during the third match of India's five-match T20I series in England and was sidelined along with spinner Varun Chakravarthy. The scans revealed later that Rana had suffered a Grade 1 hamstring injury, with the fast bowler reporting

to the Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru. A similar hamstring injury had ruled the 24-year-old fast bowler from the T20 World Cup which India won for a second consecutive time and third overall. Washington, who had come in as the replacement for Chakravarthy, later suffered a hamstring injury during the third ODI against England and he also has been at the COE for recovery. All-rounder Reddy had been side-

lined from India's tours of Ireland and England in late June. His injury had aggravated during India's third ODI against Afghanistan in Chennai and the 23-year-old was sent to the COE for at least a month but failed to recover for the Sri Lanka series. Reddy had picked up the injury in the first ODI and was rested from the second. However, he complained of discomfort in the third ODI after bowling six overs.

Duleep Trophy: East Zone oust Central Zone by 4 wickets to enter final



G UNNIKRISHNAN ■ Bengaluru

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's cameo sat well with fiery spells by Bengal pacers Mohammed Shami and Mukesh Kumar, powering East Zone to the Duleep Trophy final with a four-wicket win over defending champions Central Zone on the third day of the semi-final here on Tuesday. The 2012-13 season winners will face either South Zone or North Zone in the final at Chepauk, starting on September 6. Shami and Mukesh shared seven wickets among them to bundle out Central for 158 in their second innings, and then scaled down the 159-run target despite a mini

slump in the middle. On a pitch that offered increasing turn to spinners, it was vital for East to make a solid start to hunt down the target of 159. Sooryavanshi (40, 43b) played an innings of two faces - his first 15 runs

came off 30 balls, a stark contrast to his 42-ball fifty in the first innings, and contained just a six off pacer Aryan Pandey. But the remaining 25 runs came in 13 balls which had another six and three boundaries. However on the other side, his opening partner Abhimanyu Easwaran was outpacing him, scoring a six off off-spinner Saransh Jain over long-on. Sooryavanshi, who offered a broad bat to spinners, could only be awakened by the sight of pacer Yash Thakur, whom he had carted for four fours and two sixes in the first dig. In this innings, the left-hander blasted the pacer for three fours and a six in 14th over. (PTI)

Lad replaces Shardul as Mumbai captain for Ranji; Iyer or Suryakumar likely for white-ball captaincy

DEVARCHIT VARMA ■ Mumbai

Seasoned middle-order batter Siddhesh Lad has replaced Shardul Thakur as Mumbai captain for the upcoming Ranji Trophy season and either Shreyas Iyer or Suryakumar Yadav will lead the side in white-ball domestic tournaments depending on their availability.

Thakur, 34, has been replaced to manage his workload since the Mumbai think tank aims to maximise his value as the premier bowler in the red-ball team. He has also contributed heavily with the bat in crunch situations in the past. It is for a second consecutive season that Mumbai will enter the Ranji Trophy with a new captain at the helm. Ahead of the 2025-26 season, Thakur had



replaced Ajinkya Rahane. Rahane, who retired this year in July from all formats, had led Mumbai to their record-extending 42nd Ranji Trophy title win in 2023-24 with a compelling victory over Vidarbha in summit clash. Mumbai will also be looking to maximise their leadership options in white-ball cricket with the incumbent India T20I captain

Shreyas and his predecessor Suryakumar both in fray for the captaincy role. "We have both Shreyas Iyer and Suryakumar Yadav as the choice for white-ball captaincy, but it depends on their availability," a senior official from MCA said. Iyer earlier replaced Suryakumar as the captain of the Indian T20I team, a few months after the latter guided the national side to

their second consecutive and overall third title win in T20 World Cup in February this year. Iyer, meanwhile, had also led Mumbai to Syed Mushtaq Ali T20 Trophy victory in 2024-25. Under Thakur, Mumbai had finished at the quarterfinal stage of the Ranji Trophy 2025-26, losing to eventual runner-up Karnataka in the last eight clash at home. (PTI)

Marsh, Head return for ODIs against Zimbabwe, SA as Labuschagne misses out

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Sydney

Top-order batter Marnus Labuschagne was a notable omission while skipper Mitchell Marsh and fellow opener Travis Head returned to the 17-member Australia squad for the ODI series against Zimbabwe and South Africa beginning later this month.

Marsh and prolific run-getter Head had missed the 50-over series in Pakistan and Bangladesh earlier this year.

The twin series, starting on September 15, assumes added significance for Australia as they begin preparations for next year's ODI World Cup, to be co-hosted by South Africa, Zimbabwe and Namibia.

Australia have named the squad without an official captain, with Marsh set to lead the side in the three-match ODI series in Zimbabwe before regular ODI and Test captain Pat Cummins returns to take charge in South Africa along with fellow pacer Mitchell Starc.

Cummins has also indicated that he will not feature in all three ODIs in South Africa, meaning Marsh is likely to



deputise once again, according to cricket.com.au. Marsh has stepped in for Cummins 15 times since the fast bowler was appointed Australia's ODI captain. Youngsters Joel Davies and Ollie Peake have retained their places in the squad following decent performances during Australia's recent series in Pakistan and Bangladesh.

The three ODIs against Zimbabwe will be played in Harare on September 15, 18 and 20, followed by a three-match

series against South Africa in Durban (September 24), Johannesburg (September 27) and Potchefstroom (September 30). Cummins and Starc have been named for South Africa leg of ODI series as Australia are scheduled to follow it with three Tests against Proteas in October. "This six-game series is an important lead-in to next year's World Cup, being played in the same countries, for the group," selection chief George Bailey said. (PTI)

Gurnoor Brar: Learning lengths, aim to become all-format bowler

G UNNIKRISHNAN ■ Bengaluru

India pacer Gurnoor Brar says bowling alongside senior quicks Jasprit Bumrah and Mohammad Siraj in the last three months has helped him find consistency in lengths and he is now aiming to become an all-format pacer capable of taking heavy workload. Brar has made a reasonable beginning to his national

career, taking 11 wickets across six ODIs with an economy that hovers around seven. But the 26-year-old thinks that he would be able to better that with the newly-acquired know-how on lengths after his stints with the national team during ODI series against Afghanistan and England. "I got selected to the India



team because of the way I was performing in the Ranji Trophy and India A. But I was looking for more learnings as to how I can be more consistent on my lengths and which batsman I can bowl according to which wicket. That was my aim," Brar told select media on the sidelines of the ongoing Duleep Trophy where he is playing for North Zone. (PTI)

Teams free to arrange hotels if they feel: Japan Cricket CEO

KUSHAN SARKAR ■ New Delhi

Participating teams have been offered hotel stay but they are free to make their own arrangements during the upcoming Asian Games, Japan Cricket Association CEO Naoki Alex Miyaji said on Wednesday after concerns expressed by leading nations over the accommodation provided



for the continental event. At a recent Asian Cricket Council (ACC) meeting, top cricketing nations had expressed their apprehensions

about logistical issues including accommodation which is 20kms from the Korogi Sports Park in Nishin City in Aichi Prefecture. "The Asian Games is being organised by the organising committee Aichi-Nagoya Games Organizing Committee (AINAGOC) in collaboration with the ACC under Olympic Council of Asia (OCA)," Miyaji said. (PTI)



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फॉर्म-6

नए मतदाता के लिए

यदि आप 18 वर्ष की आयु पूर्ण कर चुके हैं और आपका नाम मतदाता सूची में नहीं है, तो फॉर्म-6 भरे



नया नाम जोड़ने हेतु

फॉर्म-7

नाम हटाने के लिए

यदि किसी का नाम मतदाता सूची में है, लेकिन उसकी मृत्यु हो गई है या स्थान परिवर्तन किया है, तो फॉर्म-7 भरे।



नाम हटाने हेतु

फॉर्म-8

विवरण सुधारने के लिए

यदि आपके नाम, आयु, पता, फोटो या अन्य विवरण में कोई गलती है, या फिर स्थान परिवर्तन किया है, तो फॉर्म 8 भरे



विवरण सुधारने हेतु

कृपया फॉर्म 6 व 8 के साथ आवश्यक दस्तावेज एवं घोषणा-पत्र अवश्य संलग्न करें।

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